RNI NO.: DELENG/2005/15351

Millenniumpost

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PUBLISHED FROM DELHI | KOLKATA | SILIGURI | FRIDAY, OCTOBER 16, 2026 | NEW DELHI | PAGES 12 | Rs 4.00 | VOL.21, ISSUE 287



REKHA TO OPPN: DEBATE DEVELOPMENT, NOT ATTIRE P3



MODI INAUGURATES FIVE KEY PROJS WORTH RS 3,350 CRORE IN LADAKH P5

ISHITA GETS NERVOUS AROUND AJAY DEVGN & TABU P12

DIPKE URGES YOUTH, PARTIES TO UNITE

HC refuses to restrain CJP's Tiranga march, NDMC shuts Central Park

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, October 15



The Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) 'Lehra Do Tiranga' protest is set to test the authorities' handling of demonstrations in central Delhi, after the Delhi High Court on Thursday declined to restrain CJP from holding its protest at Connaught Place's Central Park on Friday, October 16, recording the Delhi Police's assurance that it would take "all possible measures under the law" to regulate the gathering. Hours later, the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) announced that the park would remain closed to the general public on October 16 and 17 for "administrative reasons", leaving it unclear whether protesters would be permitted to enter.

CLOSER LOOK

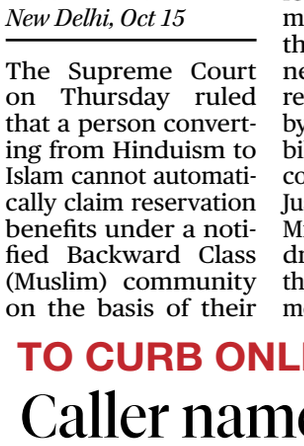
- Delhi Police urges public to avoid CJP Tiranga march
- NDMC shuts Central Park ahead of CJP protest
- AAP to join CJP's Tiranga march in Delhi
- Delhi tightens security ahead of CJP protest
- Delhi Police offers alternative venue for flag event
- CJP protest puts Delhi authorities on alert
- Traders fear festive season disruptions from CJP march

» CJP CALLS FOR NATIONWIDE TIRANGA MARCHES

Meanwhile, Delhi Police has urged people to stay away from the CJP proposed 'Lehra Do Tiranga' march, while offering to facilitate a select group of people to wave the national flag and sing the national anthem at a suitable location. In a statement, police said prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) were in force in Connaught Place and adjoining areas to maintain peace and protect lives and public and private property. Police said trader and market associations had sought protection for their establishments against unruly elements and unlawful assemblies that could disrupt business during the festive season. Warning that violations of the prohibitory orders would invite legal action, police appealed to the public to cooperate in maintaining peace and tranquillity. It also said the national flag must be displayed and the national anthem sung in the prescribed manner, with due respect, dignity and decorum. CONTINUED ON P4

SC issues notice to CEC, ECs on Rahul Gandhi's plea for probe into 'irregularities'

Nobody can browbeat judiciary, says CJI on plea concerning Oct 12 march to SC



MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 15

The Supreme Court on Thursday sought responses from the Election Commission of India and Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar on a petition filed by Congress leader Rahul Gandhi and 12 other opposition leaders alleging large-scale voter deletions and irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. In separate proceedings concerning an opposition march to the court on October 12, Chief Justice of India Surya Kant said the judiciary would not be intimidated by political demonstrations and indicated that the conduct of one of the petitioners would be examined at the next hearing. CONTINUED ON P4

SC seeks Centre, Delhi Police response on Jantar Mantar's removal as protest site

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 15

The Supreme Court on Thursday sought responses from the Centre and Delhi Police on a petition challenging the withdrawal of Jantar Mantar's status as a designated protest site and the selection of three alternative venues for demonstrations.

A bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi said it would examine whether authorities had properly assessed Jantar Mantar's suitability and effectiveness as a protest location.

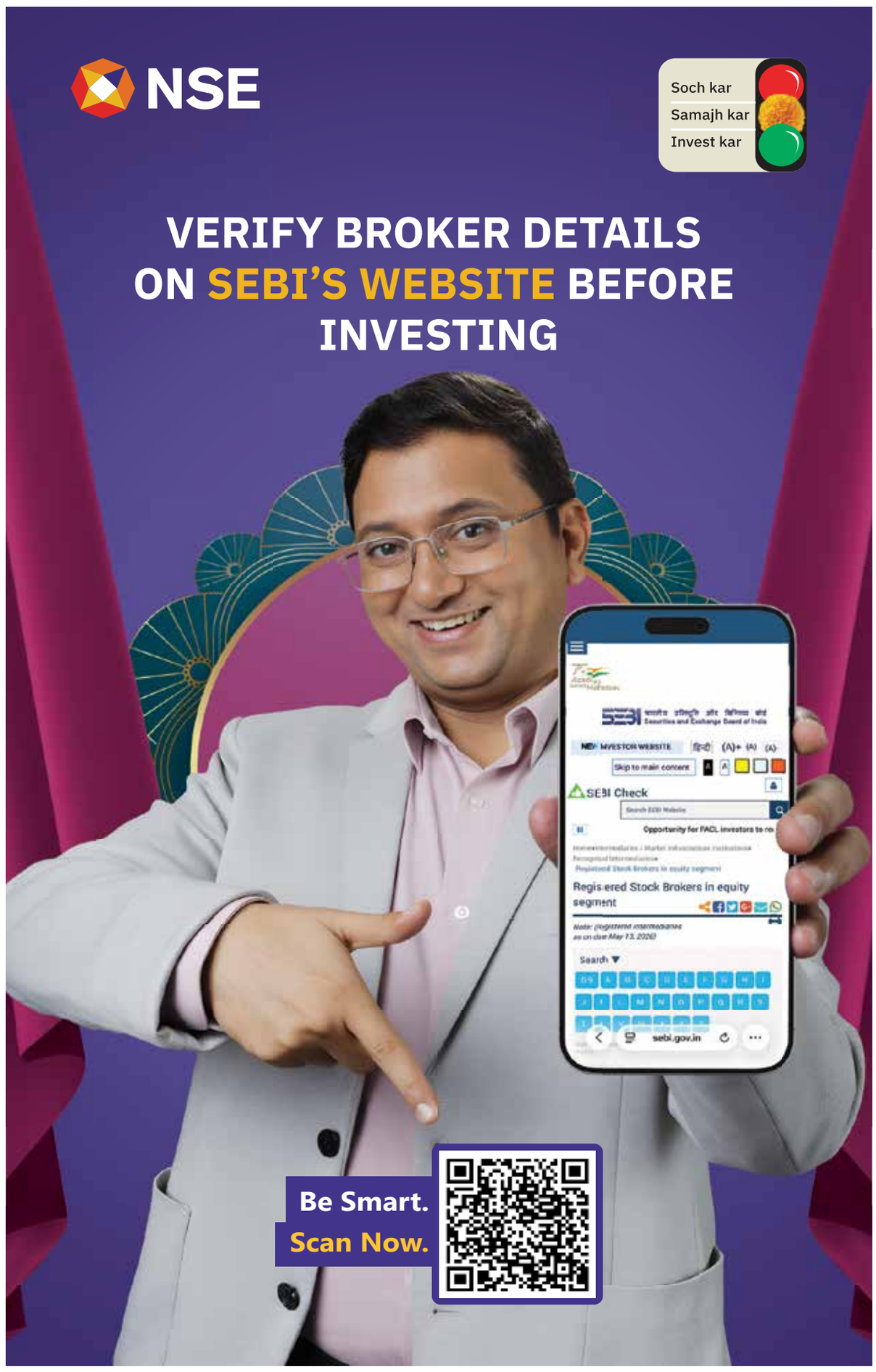
The October 11 standing order issued by Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar designated CONTINUED ON P4

EC orders annual voter roll revision in 17 states

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15

The Election Commission on Thursday ordered an annual special summary revision (SSR) of electoral rolls in 17 states and Union territories, including five states scheduled to hold assembly elections early next year. The final voter lists will be published on January 4, 2027, with January 1, 2027, set as the qualifying date for enrolment.

The exercise aims to register eligible voters, particularly young and first-time electors, correct errors in existing entries and improve the accuracy of electoral rolls. A senior EC functionary said the annual revision is CONTINUED ON P4



SC rules converts cannot claim backward-class quota solely on past caste status

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, Oct 15

The Supreme Court on Thursday ruled that a person converting from Hinduism to Islam cannot automatically claim reservation benefits under a notified Backward Class (Muslim) community on the basis of their former caste or community status, holding that social backwardness in the previous religious order cannot, by itself, establish eligibility under a different community. A bench of Justices Prashant Kumar Mishra and Shree Chandrashekhar dismissed the Tamil Nadu government's plea CONTINUED ON P4

TO CURB ONLINE FRAUD

Caller name display must from Nov 1: DoT

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15



The Department of Telecommunications (DoT) has directed telecom operators to introduce a service displaying callers' names on 4G and 5G mobile networks from November 1, 2026, in a move aimed at curbing online fraud. The facility, known as Calling Name Presentation (CNAP), will enable recipients to identify incoming callers using information maintained by telecom service providers.

In a circular dated October 13, the department said operators had conducted trials to introduce CNAP on 4G and higher-generation networks. It instructed all service providers to roll out the facility across their respective service areas from November 1. CONTINUED ON P4



AQI on Thursday: 149

Friday, October 16, 2026
NEW DELHI

Temp on Thursday
MAX 28.1°C MIN 23.3°C

FORECAST

Millenniumpost

Heavy security ahead of CJP's protest at CP

Party plans simultaneous marches in other cities

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15



Heavy security will be in place in and around Connaught Place and Jantar Mantar ahead of the CJP's proposed protest on October 16, with several companies of paramilitary forces already stationed in the national capital, police sources said on Thursday.

The protest, titled "Lehra do Tiranga", has been called by Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) founder Abhijeet Dipke at Central Park in Connaught Place at 5 pm on Friday.

Police will deploy personnel at strategic locations, erect barricades and regulate the movement of protesters and commuters to maintain law and order and prevent any untoward incident, a source said.

A senior police officer said Connaught Place is not a designated protest site.

"Jantar Mantar has been denotified as a designated protest site. Protesters can hold demonstrations at Ramlila Maidan, Burari Ground or CBD Ground after obtaining the requisite permission," the officer said.

The proposed demonstration was announced after CJP leaders Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka were arrested after reaching Jantar Mantar and remanded to five days of judicial custody by a Special Executive Magistrate.

In a statement, Dipke urged citizens to join the demonstration, asserting that waving the national flag was a democratic right.

The party has also called for parallel Tiranga marches in other cities at 5 pm on Friday.

CLOSER LOOK

- **Dipke urged citizens to join the demonstration, asserting that waving the national flag was a democratic right**
- **The proposed demonstration was announced after CJP leaders Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka were arrested after reaching Jantar Mantar and remanded to five days of judicial custody by a Special Executive Magistrate**
- **'Jantar Mantar has been denotified as a designated protest site. Protesters can hold demonstrations at Ramlila Maidan, Burari Ground or CBD Ground after obtaining the permission'**
- **Police will deploy personnel at strategic locations, erect barricades and regulate the movement of protesters...**

Police urge public to avoid CP protest

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15

The Delhi Police on Thursday urged people to stay away from the proposed protest at Connaught Place on Friday, warning of strict action over the use of the national flag and possible disruption of business.

In a statement, the police said prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) were in force in Connaught Place and adjoining areas to maintain peace and protect life and property.

The New Delhi Municipal Council has informed the police that Central Park will remain closed to visitors on October 16 and 17 for administrative reasons, and sought security personnel for the sensitive, congested area.

Traders' and market committees have also raised concerns about the potential impact on business during the festive season, the police said, adding that the issue had been raised in the Delhi High Court.

The police told the court that appropriate measures would address these concerns, while allowing that flag-hoisting and patriotic activities could be held at a suitable venue with due dignity and respect.

Tighten the final court paragraphMake the opening more concise

'CASTEIST' REMARKS AGAINST COP

SC directs no coercive action against scribe in FIR by ACP

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15



The Supreme Court on Thursday directed that no coercive action be taken against a woman journalist accused of making casteist remarks against Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP) Vivek Bhagat, after she alleged that the case was a counterblast to her sexual harassment complaint against the officer.

A bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi passed the order while hearing a petition by the Network of Women in Media, India (NWMI), highlighting violence and sexual harassment faced by women journalists covering protests in the Capital on October 10 and earlier.

Senior advocate Indira Jaising, representing NWMI, sought an independent commission comprising predominantly former women judges, IPS officers, eminent citizens and social activists to investigate allegations against police personnel. The bench termed the allegations "very serious" and permitted her to submit, in a sealed cover, the identities of women journalists willing to file written complaints and suggestions for the proposed committee.

"There are allegations against certain police officers. We are considering whether there must be an independent committee to probe them... consequences under the law must follow," the court said.

The bench stressed that journalists required additional protection, while raising questions about who could claim journalistic status in the digital era. Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the police, urged the court to await its response before deciding on an independent commission. He also questioned the authenticity of a video submitted by the journalist, suggesting it could be AI-generated.

Jaising called for a standard operating procedure to address harassment of women journalists, saying they faced violence while covering protests at Jantar Mantar despite working without similar obstacles in war zones. Mehta opposed a blanket order, citing allegations of harassment against women police personnel as well.

Senior advocate Gaurav Bhatia raised a separate allegation that a three-month-pregnant journalist was pushed by Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi during an incident at the Supreme Court on October 12, leaving her injured and requiring hospitalisation. Jaising accused him of politicising the matter. The court said it could examine the issue if a petition was filed.

Earlier, the Delhi High Court declined an urgent hearing on the journalist's plea challenging the case against her, agreeing to hear it on Friday.

The FIR, registered on Tuesday, names the journalist and two others under Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita provisions relating to obstructing a public servant, defamation and joint liability, besides the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act. The petition termed the FIR a misuse of power and a counterblast to her October 3 complaint at Parliament Street police station, alleging a 10-day delay in reporting the incident against the swift registration of the case.

The journalist alleged Bhagat touched her inappropriately and pushed her while she recorded a Left activist's detention on October 3. He denied the allegations, and police referred her complaint to the crime branch for an impartial inquiry.

AISF, AIYF seek SIR rollback, CEC's resignation

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, October 15

The All India Students' Federation (AISF) and the All India Youth Federation (AIYF) on Thursday organised a Tiranga March from Connaught Place towards Jantar Mantar, demanding the scrapping of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and the restoration of Jantar Mantar as a designated protest site. Around 150 protesters were arrested by Delhi Police, the organisations said.

The protesters, carrying the national flag, opposed the de-notification of Jantar Mantar as a protest site, calling it an attack on the democratic right to peaceful assembly. The organisations said the site had historically served as a venue for public dissent and movements seeking justice.

The march was led by AIYF president Raushan Kumar Sinha, general secretary Sukhjinder Mahesari, AISF Delhi State convenor Aniket Madke and co-convenors Shubham and Mohit.

The organisations also demanded the immediate release of (CJP) leaders Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das, who they said had been imprisoned for hoisting the Tricolour. They accused the authorities of using restrictions and police action to suppress dissent.

AISF and AIYF alleged that the SIR exercise could exclude eligible voters from electoral rolls, undermining their voting rights.

DAY 12

200 join JNU hunger strike

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, October 15

More than 200 students joined the mass relay hunger strike organised by the Jawaharlal Nehru University Students' Union (JNUSU) on Thursday, expressing solidarity with its indefinite hunger strike, which entered its 12th day.

The union is demanding the revocation of the rustication of its office-bearers and former president, rollback of the CPO Manual, restoration of the Jawaharlal Nehru University Entrance Examination (JNUEE) and the Gender Sensitisation Committee Against Sexual Harassment (GSCASH).

Its demands also include reconstitution of the Equal Opportunity Cell in line with the Rohith Act and resolution of long-pending campus infrastructure issues.

JNUSU said the health of hunger strikers was deteriorating, with all reportedly losing more than 4 kg, blood sugar levels falling below the average range and ketone levels reaching 4+.

Despite three rounds of negotiations, the union alleged that the administration had given no concrete response and the Vice-Chancellor had not met the protesters.

Those expressing solidarity included Rajya Sabha MP John Brittas, AISA president Neha, NCP (Sharadchandra Pawar) spokesperson Anish Gawande and SFI Delhi president Nadia.

Cops to SC: Timely, lawful measures averted major public order situation

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15



Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar has told the Supreme Court that timely, proportionate and lawful measures helped avert a major public order situation during the October 10 protests in the national capital.

In an affidavit filed in a contempt case, Kumar tendered an unconditional and unqualified apology to the apex court and said preventive measures, including regulation of Metro services, were based on intelligence inputs and assessments of the evolving ground situation.

He said the steps were aimed at maintaining peace and tranquillity, adding that Delhi's status as the national capital demanded particular sensitivity to public order.

The affidavit cited the alleged history of mob violence, property damage and injuries linked to the organisation behind the protest, and said an incorrect narrative was being propagated about the police response.

The contempt case concerns alleged violation of the Supreme Court's direction that there should be no "complete prohibition" on Metro and train services during the protest.

On October 11, the court found a prima facie case and issued notices to Kumar, Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan and DMRC Chairperson D Thara. The protest was called by the Cockroach Janta Party seeking Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation over alleged electoral irregularities.

Six held in Najafgarh extortion firing case

New Delhi, October 15

The Delhi Police Crime Branch has arrested six people in connection with a shooting at Bhawana Medicos in Najafgarh on September 19, allegedly linked to an extortion demand of Rs 5 crore over a property deal.

Police said two motorcyclists fired at Sanjay Kumar Rohilla, but the bullet missed after the gun jammed.

The accused allegedly include a man linked to Germany-based Naveen Deshwal, who is said to be associated with gangster Kapil Sangwan. Police recovered two firearms, three cartridges and a Kia Sonet car. MPOST

IGL launches AI pilot at 10 CNG stns

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15

SYSTEM USES STN CAMERAS TO CAPTURE VEHICLE NUMBERS, CHECKS HYDROTEST STATUS OF ONBOARD CNG CYLINDERS...

Indraprastha Gas Limited (IGL) has launched an artificial intelligence-powered system at 10 CNG stations to identify vehicles with expired or invalid cylinder hydrotest certificates before refuelling, adding an automated verification layer to existing safety checks.

The pilot project was launched at the Shantipath CNG station on Thursday by Dr Sanjay Kumar Singh, Joint Chief Controller of Explosives (North Circle) at the Petroleum and Explosives Safety Organisation (PESO), in the presence of IGL Managing Director Kumar Shanker, Director (Commercial) Mohit Bhatia and senior officials.

The system uses station cameras to capture vehicle registration numbers and checks the hydrotest status of onboard CNG cylinders through an artificial intelligence application linked to PESO's online portal.

If a certificate has expired or is invalid, alerts are sent to station personnel through handheld devices, LED displays and public announcement systems, allowing staff to intervene before refuelling.

The technology supplements manual verification by station staff under Rule 35(1) of the Gas Cylinders Rules, as amended in 2025.

Appreciating IGL's efforts, Singh described the initiative as "a nascent step towards safety that can be rolled out at large scale". He said it was important for supporting the increase in natural gas's share in the overall energy mix to 15%, as well as future hydrogen blending.

IGL has strengthened safety checks, launched a CNG cylinder awareness campaign and will assess its pilot project before considering wider expansion.

Class 12 student stabbed to death outside school; 3 minors among 5 apprehended: Cops

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15

A 17-year-old class 12 student was allegedly stabbed to death outside a government school in southwest Delhi's Mohan Garden area following a dispute over school uniform shoes, police said on Thursday.

Five accused, including three juveniles, have been apprehended in connection with the incident that took place at around 6.10 pm on Wednesday near the Government Senior Secondary School, they said.

The injured student was taken to a private hospital, where he died during treatment, police said.

The victim lived in Mohan Garden. His father is an ex-serviceman who works as a security guard in Gurugram, they added.

According to a witness, the dispute began after the victim was reported to a teacher for not wearing the prescribed school shoes.

After school hours, an argument escalated into a fight, during which one of the accused allegedly stabbed the student, a police officer said.

The knife allegedly used in the crime was recovered near the school gate. A murder case has been registered, and further investigation is underway, police said.

2020 DELHI RIOTS

Court acquits 5, says police tried to fill gaps

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15



A Delhi court has acquitted five men accused of rioting and attempting to murder a man during the 2020 northeast Delhi riots, saying the investigating agency appeared to have tried to "fill the lacuna" in the case and failed to establish their presence at the spot where the victim was injured.

Additional Sessions Judge Sameer Bajpai was hearing a case against five men -- Raj Kumar, Deepak Tomar, Gurmeet Singh, Gaurav and Vikram -- accused of rioting, rioting with deadly weapons, unlawful assembly, attempt to murder and common intention under the IPC. The proceedings against Vikram had already been abated by the court on July 15 after his death.

In an order dated October 14, the court said, "The court must take note of the fact that the FIR in the present case was registered three days after the incident... surprisingly, the statements of Head Constables Sonu and Rafiq were recorded at a much later stage, which shows that the investigating agency tried to fill the lacuna in order to make out a case and resolve the same." The court said the prosecution's case rested primarily on the identification of the accused through CCTV footage and photographs, which constituted weak evidence, particularly as the police witness was not previously acquainted with them. The case pertained to an incident on February 25, 2020 near Kardampuri Puliya, where a man named Rizwan sustained a bullet injury to his head amid the violence.

> **IN COURT, RIZWAN DID NOT SUPPORT THE PROSECUTION'S CLAIM REGARDING THE IDENTIFICATION OF THE ACCUSED THROUGH PHOTOGRAPHS**

Advocates Shakeel Ahmad and Shawed Jameel, the counsels representing accused Raj Kamal, Gaurav and Gurmeet Singh, submitted that the prosecution's case was false and the accused were not present at the spot at the time of the incident.

They argued that the injured man, Rizwan, and other public witnesses neither named nor identified the accused in their statements or court testimony.

The court noted that even in a supplementary statement recorded around seven months later, he did not name them but only identified five persons allegedly present at the spot after being shown photographs.

During his testimony in court, Rizwan did not support the prosecution's claim regarding the identification of the accused through photographs.

The court also noted that the statements of two other public witnesses, Rizwan's brother Sartaj and his friend Kasim, did not help establish the accused persons' involvement.

The court acquitted the accused, citing weak evidence, lack of identification by the victim and public witnesses, and unproven CCTV footage, concluding that the prosecution failed to establish their presence or involvement in the riots.

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Printed and Published by Jaiyendra Kumar Sharma on behalf of Front Row Media Pvt. Ltd. and printed at The Indian Express Pvt. Ltd., A-8, Sector-7, Noida-201 301 (U.P.) and published from First Floor, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002. Editor: Durbar Ganguly. Email: editor@millenniumpost.in, Tel. No. 011-47777500, Kolkata office: Room No 1,15th Floor, Chatterjee International Centre, 33A Jawaharlal Nehru Road, Kolkata 700071 West Bengal, Siliguri Office: Techno India Group Zonal Office G-212, 2nd Floor Office Block - City Centre Matigara District Darjeeling Pin - 734010 Phone- 0353- 2576321

GOVT TARGETS 2.30 LAKH ROOFTOP INSTALLATIONS BY MARCH 2027; 77,614 APPLICATIONS RECEIVED SO FAR

Solar Drive: Delhi's next power station could be your rooftop

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, October 15

Delhi's rooftop solar drive is drawing registrations from across the Capital, with applications spread relatively evenly among the three major electricity distribution companies, as the government targets 2.30 lakh rooftop solar installations by March 31, 2027.

The registration portal, launched on September 21, had received 77,614 applications by October 9. The distribution of applications suggests that interest extends across different parts of the city rather than being concentrated in a single discom area. BSES Yamuna Power Limited (BYPL) recorded 27,197 registrations, followed by Tata Power Delhi Distribution Limited (TPDDL) with 26,788 and BSES Rajdhani Power Limited (BRPL) with 23,925. The difference between the highest and second-highest totals is just 409 applications.

Power Minister Ashish Sood said the response from rural areas and unauthorised colonies had been particularly encouraging. "This shows the immense trust and enthusiasm of our citizens," he said.

The government's target is to expand rooftop solar access while helping households reduce electricity expenses and encouraging decentralised clean-energy generation. The scale of the potential rollout is significant: Delhi had around 61 lakh domestic electricity consumers in 2024-25, leaving a large pool of households that could potentially explore rooftop solar, subject to eligibility and technical feasibility.



Under the revised Delhi Solar Energy Policy, eligible domestic consumers with average monthly consumption of up to 400 units can receive rooftop solar systems of up to 3 kW without paying the installation cost upfront, subject to the scheme's conditions. The Centre provides a subsidy of up to Rs 78,000, while the Delhi government has announced an additional subsidy of up to Rs 78,000. The combined support can reach Rs 1.56 lakh for eligible systems.

The policy also seeks to make solar adoption easier for group housing societies. The Delhi government has increased its subsidy for rooftop systems serving common facilities from Rs 2,000 to Rs 11,000 per kW, up to 500 kW, with eligible projects also able to receive central assistance.

For households, the benefits can extend beyond reducing electricity bills. Consumers may also sell surplus power to distribution companies under applicable arrangements.

The revised policy further provides for five years of free maintenance, while the government has said the time required for residential net metering would be reduced from around 75 days to 25 days.

The next phase will depend on translating registrations into installed and operational systems. The March deadline makes installation progress, commissioning and the capacity added to Delhi's rooftop solar network key indicators of the scheme's reach.

TARGETS AAP, CONGRESS

Rekha to Oppn: Debate development, not attire

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday criticised the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) and Congress, accusing them of focusing on her sarees, footwear and personal activities instead of raising issues concerning public welfare.

Questioning the Opposition's priorities, Gupta said "political parties should concentrate on development and matters of public interest rather than commenting on her attire and personal engagements."

The Chief Minister also questioned the Opposition's response to reports of killings and drug trafficking in Punjab, asking why these



issues were not receiving similar attention. She further referred to allegations of sexual exploitation of female students by a professor at Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU), saying such serious matters warranted attention.

Her remarks came amid a political exchange over criticism directed at her public appearances and activities. Gupta maintained that the Opposition should scrutinise the work being undertaken by her government and engage in discussions on issues affecting citizens.

The Chief Minister said her administration was working to improve public services and address problems that, according to her, had remained neglected under previous governments.

Referring to the allegations concerning JNU, Gupta called for attention to issues affecting the safety and welfare of female students. The allegations have raised concerns about the need for appropriate scrutiny and action by the authorities concerned.

Delhi Ramlila to burn 30-foot 'COCKROACH' effigy alongside Ravan

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 15

A 30-foot-tall "cockroach" effigy will go up in flames alongside those of Ravan, Kumbhkaran, and Meghnad at a Ramlila in the national capital this year.

The Shree Keshav Ram Leela Committee, which organises Ramlila in Pitampura, said the insect represents "filth and dirt" and the initiative is part of the "Swachh Bharat" and "Swachh Delhi" campaigns.

Ashok Goel, the committee president and a BJP MLA, told PTI that the decision is not politically motivated.

Burning the cockroach effigy is meant to reinforce the message of the victory of good over evil and cleanliness, he said.

The "cockroach" will also feature among the 'asuras' in Ravan's army, Goel said.

The decision comes against the backdrop of the Cockroach Janata Party's protests in the national capital, first against ex-education minister Dharmendra Pradhan and now for Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation.

In June and July, the group sat in protest at Jantar Mantar for over a month and marched to Parliament on July 20, eventually forcing Pradhan to resign as minister.

The CJP has returned to the streets, joining opposition parties and student organisations in demonstrations demanding the resignation of the CEC.

Delhi to get 1 lakh LED street lights

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday launched a project to install one lakh smart LED street lights, beginning at the Andrews Ganj bus stop, to address dark spots and improve women's safety and public convenience across the Capital. The initiative follows concerns raised by female students during Gupta's recent interaction at Delhi University. The lights will be monitored in real time through a central command centre, with QR codes on each light enabling citizens to access information and register complaints.

The project targets 99 per cent functionality, with faulty lights required to be repaired within 48 hours of a complaint. Agencies missing the deadline will face a penalty of Rs 2,000 per light per day.

Hindu Rao Hospital nurses call off strike

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, October 15

HIGHLIGHTS

» **The nurses agreed to end their protest following the assurance that 50 to 80% of the staff requirement would be met within 60 days**

» **As part of the understanding, the recruitment process is to begin with posts through the Delhi Subordinate Services Selection Board (DSSSB)**

Nurses at Delhi's Hindu Rao Hospital called off their strike on October 8 after the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) Additional Commissioner assured them that steps would be taken to address the staff shortage by December.

The nurses agreed to end their protest following the assurance that 50 to 80 per cent of the staff requirement would be met within 60 days. As part of the understanding, the recruitment process is to begin with posts through the Delhi Subordinate Services Selection Board (DSSSB). The assurance comes after nurses had been protesting since September 28, demanding that vacant nursing positions be filled to ease the workload on the existing staff.

The hospital has 300 sanctioned nursing posts, but only 62 nursing officers were working, leaving 238 posts vacant. The shortage had become the main concern for the nurses, who said the existing workforce was struggling to manage the workload. Delhi Nurses Union president Vibha Singh had said that some wards had around 40 to 50 patients with just one nursing officer available to attend to them. She also highlighted how the workload was affecting the health and family lives of the nurses who continued working despite the shortage.

The protest began with a black ribbon demonstration from September 28 to October 4, during which nurses continued their duties wearing black ribbons. From October 5, they began a two hour agitation scheduled to continue until October 11. The nurses had also warned of a total strike from October 12 if their demands remained unaddressed. However, the strike was called off on October 8 following the assurance from the MCD official. The nurses agreed to the proposed timeline, with the focus now on fulfilling the commitment to address the shortage. The key concern remains the availability of adequate nursing staff, which the union has maintained is essential for managing the workload and ensuring patients do not suffer.

Briefs

Draw of lots for 522 golf slots today

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) will hold a draw of lots on Friday for 522 membership slots at Dwarka Golf Course, with 1,505 eligible applicants in the government and non government categories. The draw will take place at 11 am at Auction Hall, D-Block, Vikas Sadan, INA. Of the available slots, 53 are under the government category and 469 under the non government category. The proceedings will be streamed live on YouTube.

Punjabi Bagh pollution checks get stricter

NEW DELHI: Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar on Thursday inspected air quality monitoring points, parking facilities and construction and demolition (C&D) waste management arrangements in Punjabi Bagh's West Zone, directing officials to strengthen pollution control measures and prevent the dumping of waste in open areas. The inspection covered Bharat Darshan Park, a designated air quality monitoring hotspot and the puzzle parking facility in Punjabi Bagh. Khirwar reviewed the identification of major pollution sources, monitoring mechanisms and steps being taken to improve air quality in the area.

Lok Nayak Hosp gets 256-slice CT scanner, 3 MRIs

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday inaugurated a Dual Source 256-slice CT scanner and three advanced MRI machines at Lok Nayak Hospital, expanding diagnostic facilities at the government-run institution. The equipment has been provided by Indian Oil Corporation Limited (IOCL) under its corporate social responsibility initiative.

The new machines are expected to strengthen diagnosis and treatment across specialities, including cardiology, oncology, neurology, urology, orthopaedics and paediatric care. They will help detect conditions such as strokes, cancers, liver and prostate diseases, and musculoskeletal disorders more accurately and quickly.

Health Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh said the CT scan and MRI facilities would be available to patients free of cost, considering the large number of people visiting the hospital, located in a densely populated area.

Gupta said her government was committed to ensuring that no citizen was denied quality healthcare because of financial constraints or other difficulties. She highlighted other facilities introduced at the hospital, including a Lactation Management Unit functioning as a milk bank, a nucleic acid testing machine for HIV and



hepatitis screening, and a dedicated ward for patients with rare diseases.

The Chief Minister also referred to the Anmol Yojana, under which newborns are screened for potential genetic disorders to enable early detection and timely treatment.

Tax revenue rises 3.5%, excise up 6%

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15

Delhi government earned Rs 2,030.38 crore in tax revenue in the first half of the current financial year, 3.5 per cent more than the same period last fiscal year, officials said on Thursday.

The total tax revenue of the government stood at Rs 32,547.70 crore as on October 9 this year, according to the official data.

The excise tax revenue in the first two quarters of the ongoing financial year stood at Rs 3,152.85 crore, up 6 per cent against Rs 2,947.53 crore recorded in the same period of 2025-26, the data showed.

The total tax revenue was Rs 26,128.48 crore up to September 2025. In the current year, it stood at Rs 27,030.38 crore up to September.

The Delhi government has estimated total tax collection of Rs 74,000 crore in 2026-27.

"Streamlined policies and targeted action have helped improve the tax collections. The collections were higher as compared to the first half of last year in almost all categories, including VAT, stamps and registration, and motor vehicles tax, among others," said a senior Delhi government officer.

The biggest contributor to Delhi's tax revenue in the first half of this year was the Goods and Services Tax (GST) with Rs 19,023.42 crore, which was higher than Rs 18,710.89 crore in the same period of the preceding fiscal year.

Other major collections up to September this year were stamps and registration fee at Rs 4,482.50 crore, value added tax (VAT) at Rs 3,826.43 crore, excise Rs 3,152.85 crore, and motor vehicle tax Rs 1,613.76 crore.

The non-tax revenue of the government up to September was Rs 778.37 crore against the 2026-27 budget estimate of Rs 900 crore, the data showed.

The grants in aid received by the Delhi government up to September were Rs 1,000.35 crore. The budget estimate of grants-in-aid for 2026-27 is Rs 7,092.07 crore. The grants received by the government included Rs 517.35 crore under Centrally Sponsored Schemes (CSS) and Rs 483 crore as grants from the Ministry of Home Affairs.

The total capital receipts of the Delhi government up to September stood at Rs 5,578.12 crore.

Woman stabbed to death by husband in N-W Delhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15

A 32-year-old woman was allegedly stabbed to death by her husband following a family dispute at their rented house in northwest Delhi's Nihal Vihar, police said on Thursday. The accused, identified as Vikas, fled after the incident, and several police teams have been formed to trace and arrest him, they said. The deceased, Ruby, was taken to Mansa Ram Hospital in Nangloi by her family members around 12.10 am on Thursday, but she was declared dead on arrival, police said. Preliminary investigation revealed that Ruby and Vikas had been living in a rented house in Laxmi Park, Nihal Vihar, for the past month along with their 10-year-old son, they said.

Dead fish found along Yamuna banks

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 15

The discovery of hundreds, possibly thousands, of dead fish along the Yamuna riverbank in Delhi's Burari has raised concerns over the health of the river's aquatic ecosystem, with experts flagging possible toxic pollution and inadequate environmental flows as contributing factors.

The cause of the fish deaths, reported on Wednesday evening, has not yet been established.

Radhey Shyam Sharma, head of the Department of Environmental Studies at Delhi University, said the sudden death of thousands of fish could indicate a sharp increase in contaminants in the water, including a possible toxic discharge.

"Sudden mass death of fish always signifies a sudden spike in some contaminant or some kind of toxic discharge, because fish are biological indicators and their death signifies a disbalance," he said. Sharma warned that such pollutants could potentially seep into groundwater, posing health risks.

He said even relatively small quantities of effluents could harm aquatic life if pollutant concentrations exceeded permissible limits, potentially causing reproductive and morphological abnormalities in fish.

LONG QUEUES & NEAR-GRIDLOCK REPORTED ACROSS KEY STRETCHES

Heavy rain brings traffic to a crawl across Delhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15

Heavy rain threw traffic out of gear across several parts of Delhi on Thursday, with junctions packed with vehicles and chaos on several roads due to waterlogging.

From India Gate and ITO to Mandi House and south Delhi, commuters flagged long queues of cars, buses and three-wheelers, with several stretches witnessing little to no movement.

Complaints poured in on social media, with motorists seeking traffic police intervention as the rain worsened congestion on already busy roads.

Rain swept across Delhi



on Thursday, with the skies appearing gloomy and overcast with dark clouds.

At Mandi House Circle, visuals showed vehicles packed tightly together. Commuters claimed that no traffic personnel were present to regulate the flow of traffic. Heavy congestion was also reported at the India Gate circle, where a commuter said on social media that traffic had been stuck for nearly 30 minutes.

Around ITO, commuters reported congestion on the Vikas Marg-ITO stretch and on roads connecting ITO to the Supreme Court and Bharat Mandapam. Heavy traffic was seen near the Supreme Court as well.

In south Delhi, vehicles queued up from the Chirag Delhi red light towards IIT Delhi and Hauz Khas.

Commuters also flagged heavy traffic near the Ashram flyover exit towards Sarai Kale Khan and Sunlight Colony, while congestion near Okhla Phase 1 was allegedly worsened by encroachments and construction materials stored on footpaths.

Heavy congestion during end-of-school hours in Model Town was worsened by waterlogging. Responding to a complaint, the traffic police said the matter had been forwarded to the concerned traffic circle for action. Waterlogging was reported near Mandi House and Geeta Colony, while heavy traffic snarls were also seen around Palam and AIIMS. The India Meteorological Department has issued a red alert for moderate rain, thunderstorms, lightning and gusty winds in the capital. Dark clouds hung over the city through much of the day.

REITERATES RESOLVE TO HOST 2036 OLYMPICS

PM meets Asian Games medal winners

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15



Prime Minister Narendra Modi met India's Asian Games medal-winners, including the gold-winning men's and women's cricket teams, here on Thursday and said the country is not just becoming a stronger force in terms of performance but also evolving into a "credible host" for major international events.

The PM posed for pictures with the medal-winners and was presented with memorabilia ranging from signed jerseys to a bow from 17-year-old recurve archery sensation Kumkum Mohod, who won two gold medals (individual and women's team) and a silver (mixed team) at the recently-concluded Games.

The contingent was accompanied by top officials of their respective governing bodies, including International Cricket Council (ICC) Chairman Jay Shah and Indian Olympic Association (IOA) President P T Usha among others. Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya was also present during the interaction that took place at the Major Dhyan Chand Stadium here.

"You have made 140 crore Indians proud. The biggest success is to make the tri-colour fly high. That's why your success is not just yours but it belongs to crores of our countrymen. I congratulate you on behalf of the entire country," the PM said in his address to the medal winners. "India is emerging in establishing itself as a credible and hospitable country for international sports events. We are bidding for the 2036 Olympics and it is our resolve that we will host the games," he asserted.

India won 85 medals at the Asian Games, including 21 gold. The count was lower than the 106 medals achieved in the previous edition in Hangzhou but the performance of India's Games debutants was heartening as they claimed 41 medals for the country.

"I especially want to congratulate our women athletes, they contributed 38 medals to our tally and 11 of those medals were gold," Modi said, lauding the cricket teams, the hockey teams and the performance of archers, who won five gold medals. "The women's hockey team ended a 44-year wait with its gold medal, it is highly appreciable," he added.

The entire men's T20 team led by Shreyas Iyer, which has a match against the West Indies in Bengaluru on Saturday, was in attendance, along with the women's team, which is due to take on Zimbabwe in a T20I in Raipur on Friday.

Harmanpreet Kaur, who captained the side to the Asiad gold before stepping down from her role a few days ago, was also present and gave a jersey signed by the medal-winning team to the PM. Her successor Smriti Mandhana also posed alongside her.

Golfer Pranavi Urs gave Modi her glove and a golf ball in a frame.

"Sankalp aur sapne ek din mein poore nahi hote (Dreams are not achieved in a day). It takes years of hard work and dedication. In the last 12 years, India has shown patience and worked hard to create a sports ecosystem," he said.

"There was a time when India would win very few medals at big event. The country did not know so many sports. We resolved to end this pessimism and the result is our increasing representation on the global stage.

"Today India is winning medals even in those sports in which we had never won a medal in the history of the Asian Games before," said Modi, referring to first-time Asiad medals im Mixed Martial Arts, Soft Tennis and some sailing competitions.

"A transparent system is in place for sports now," he added.

He also highlighted the direct financial support to athletes, including a Rs 50,000 allowance under TOPS and funding for international coaching stints.

"If there is a need to go outside the country for coaching in any sport, the government is facilitating that too and providing financial assistance for it," said Modi. Looking ahead to the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics, India's hosting of the 2030 Commonwealth Games in Ahmedabad, and the aspiration to host the 2036 Olympics, he recalled his Red Fort announcement of a nationwide village-level talent hunt.

HIGHLIGHTS

- **Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya was also present during the interaction that took place at the Major Dhyan Chand Stadium here**
- **'You have made 140 crore Indians proud. The biggest success is to make the tri-colour fly high. That's why your success is not just yours but it belongs to crores of our countrymen...'**

HC refuses to restrain CJP's Tiranga march, NDMC shuts Central Park

Continued from Page 1

The High Court was hearing a petition filed by a licensed street vendor who argued that the protest could affect traders' livelihoods during the festive season. His lawyer said traders would be "on the streets" if central Delhi lost another weekend to closures, arguing that Central Park was not an appropriate protest venue. The lawyer also alleged that preparations to shut areas had already begun. Additional Solicitor General Chetan Sharma, appearing for the authorities, told the court that steps had been taken to regulate the gathering.

Additionally, at a press conference ahead of the 5 pm demonstration, CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke appealed to young people, political parties and citizens to unite under the national flag. "I urge the youth, patriots and political parties to come and wave the Tricolour tomorrow. We must rise above political ideologies and unite," he said, calling for participation beyond political affiliations.

The Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), which has largely stayed away from the Congress-led INDIA bloc, has announced that it will participate in the CJP protest. The INDIA bloc has separately mobilised against the Election Commission's Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, with Rahul Gandhi and other leaders challenging the exercise in court. CJP has also called for simultaneous Tiranga marches across the country. Permission has been granted for a parallel protest at Mumbai's Azad Maidan.

Dipke alleged that students and young people had been dragged away during demonstrations over the past 10-15 days and that opposition leaders who joined the protests, including Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi and former chief ministers Mamata Banerjee, Arvind Kejriwal and Pinarayi Vijayan, had also been detained. Referring to Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, he said, "And all this for whom? For one man, Gyanesh Kumar."

Questioning alleged deletions of more than 13 crore voters, Dipke asked whether it was a "setting". He also alleged that railway services had been shut down following CJP's October 10 protest call, with Metro services and several stations across Delhi also affected. He questioned the deployment of forces from Jammu and Kashmir in the national capital.

The press conference, attended by All India Students' Association (AISA) president Neha Bora, Students' Federation of India leader Aishe Ghosh, All India Students' Federation president Viraaj Devang and actor Prakash Raj, was briefly disrupted when some people shouted, "Band karo... dafa ho jaao". Bora asked the organisers to have the disruptors escorted out.

Bora alleged that journalists covering the demonstrations, including reporters from The Caravan and The Quint, had been beaten, dragged and detained for hours despite carrying press cards. She claimed their cameras had been snatched and alleged that a woman journalist who approached the police with a sexual harassment complaint against Vivek Bhagat faced a counter-FIR.

The protest follows the detention of hundreds of people on October 10, when CJP supporters sought to demonstrate near Jantar Mantar against alleged electoral fraud. CJP co-convenors Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka were subsequently arrested after reaching Jantar Mantar, which had been denotified as a protest venue, and remanded to five days of judicial custody. Dipke said they had been jailed "for having raised the flag".

Security is expected to be strengthened around Connaught Place and Jantar Mantar, with paramilitary personnel deployed at several locations. Barricades and traffic restrictions may be introduced to regulate crowds and prevent untoward incidents.

SC issues notice to CEC, ECs on Rahul Gandhi's plea for probe into...

Continued from Page 1

A bench comprising Chief Justice Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi issued notices to the poll panel, Kumar and Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi on the petition challenging the alleged irregularities in the revision process.

During the hearing, the Chief Justice took note of statements made both inside and outside the courtroom following the October 12 march by opposition leaders to the Supreme Court premises. The march was organised to protest alleged voter deletions and what the opposition has described as vote theft.

"Nobody can browbeat us," the CJI said, adding that the court was aware of developments and statements surrounding the issue.

"We are not sitting in ivory towers. We know what statements they are making outside and what they are saying in court. We know everything," he said.

The Chief Justice also said the bench would question one of the petitioners about his conduct at the next hearing, without identifying the individual.

The observations came amid tensions between the Congress and the judiciary following criticism by a state unit of the party that had sought the CJI's resignation over his remarks that law and order fell within the executive's domain.

The main petition has sought the formation of an independent committee headed by a retired Supreme Court judge and assisted by technical experts and eminent citizens. The proposed panel would conduct an audit, within a fixed timeframe, of deletions and modifications made to electoral rolls during the SIR exercise.

The petitioners have also asked the court to ensure that no voter's name is removed without prior notice and a reasonable opportunity to be heard, as required by law. They have sought protection for eligible voters in Punjab and other states heading towards elections, allowing them to apply for inclusion in the electoral rolls until the last date permitted under the law. Seeking interim relief, the petitioners have asked the court to suspend the ongoing SIR process across states until the legal issues raised in the case are decided.

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, Trinamool Congress MP Saugata Roy, Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav, Rashtriya Janata Dal leader Tejashwi Prasad Yadav, Nationalist Congress Party (Sharad Pawar) leader Supriya Sule, Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Sanjay Raut and Communist Party of India leader D Raja are among the other petitioners.

Senior advocates Abhishek Singhvi and Kapil Sibal appeared in the matter for the petitioners, with Singhvi beginning the submissions by referring to collective decision-making within the Election Commission and changes involving Form 6, the application used by eligible individuals to seek inclusion in electoral rolls. Solicitor General Tushar Mehta sought clarification on who was representing Gandhi.

Court issues notices over October 12 march

In a separate petition challenging the October 12 march to the Supreme Court, the bench issued notices to Gandhi, Kharge, Akhilesh Yadav, Trinamool Congress MP Mahua Moitra, the Congress party, the Kerala Pradesh Congress Committee and others.

Senior advocate Gaurav Bhatia, appearing for the petitioners, argued that the gathering inside the court premises was unacceptable and that political demonstrations should not be allowed to interfere with judicial proceedings.

"It was completely unacceptable that the Supreme Court was seized with a political procession," Bhatia told the bench.

He said more than 200 lawyers had signed a memorandum expressing concern about the events and sought preservation of CCTV footage from the court premises.

Bhatia also alleged that a pregnant woman journalist had been pushed during the gathering and had to be hospitalised. The bench said the CCTV footage would be preserved. The petition has sought a complete ban on political demonstrations within the Supreme Court premises and contempt proceedings against leaders accused of obstructing the judicial system.

The October 12 march, described by its participants as a "March for Democracy", brought opposition leaders, activists and civil society members to the court to submit a joint petition against the SIR process. Protests demanding Kumar's resignation over alleged electoral irregularities have also taken place elsewhere in the national capital.

The court separately issued notices to the Election Commission and other respondents on a petition by AIMIM chief Asaduddin Owaisi seeking to set aside the SIR exercise. His plea referred to a report in The Indian Express alleging differences between election commissioners Sandhu and Joshi over important decisions. Centre defends measures during October 10 protest The Supreme Court also heard submissions in contempt proceedings concerning alleged violations of its October 9 directions on maintaining Metro and train services in Delhi during a protest called by the Cockroach Janta Party on October 10.

Solicitor General Mehta told the bench that affidavits filed by government authorities began with unconditional apologies in accordance with established court procedure. He said the documents subsequently explained and defended the actions taken, and objected to media and social media accounts portraying the opening statements as admissions of wrongdoing.

The Chief Justice said media coverage was not relevant to the court's proceedings. Justice Bagchi said the court was not taking cognisance of the reported unconditional apologies, while Mehta maintained that the apologies were followed by the authorities' explanations and factual submissions.

Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan and Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar filed affidavits addressing the measures taken during the protest. Mohan said Delhi Police had requested a suspension of cellular internet services for one day and that the proposal had been assessed under the law as proportionate to the prevailing public order situation.

According to his affidavit, cellular internet services were suspended from 10 pm on October 9 until 10 pm on October 10 within a four-kilometre radius of Raisina Hill. The restriction did not cover Wi-Fi, broadband or other non-cellular internet services.

Kumar said preventive measures, including the regulation of Metro services, were based on intelligence inputs and assessments of the evolving situation. He cited concerns about potential violence and damage to public and private property, referring to events associated with the organisation and subsequent developments on October 6, 7 and 8.

From page 1

SC seeks

Ramlila Ground, Burari Ground and CBD Ground in east Delhi as alternative venues. The petition, filed by advocate Swaty Singh, challenged the decision, arguing that shifting protests to distant areas could weaken the fundamental rights to peaceful assembly and freedom of expression.

Senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan sought restoration of Jantar Mantar's designation. Solicitor General Tushar Mehta clarified that the decision was based on a committee report, not an earlier Supreme Court order.

The court directed Delhi Police to submit prohibitory orders issued under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, formerly Section 144 of the CrPC, over the past fortnight. It also ordered law enforcement agencies to preserve CCTV footage and other digital evidence related to protests.

The petition argued that accessibility, visibility and proximity to relevant government institutions are essential to ensuring demonstrations effectively reach their intended audience.

EC orders

mandated under election law and is conducted specifically in poll-bound states.

The revision will cover Andaman and Nicobar Islands, Assam, Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Goa, Gujarat, Kerala, Lakshadweep, Madhya Pradesh, Manipur, Puducherry, Punjab, Rajasthan, Tamil Nadu, Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand and West Bengal.

The commission said voters turning 18 on or before January 1, 2027, would be encouraged to submit enrolment forms. This will allow eligible young people to register ahead of elections in Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Goa, Manipur and Punjab.

Unlike the special intensive revision (SIR), the SSR will not involve door-to-door visits by booth-level officers (BLOs), as the intensive exercise has already been completed in these states and most electors have been identified. Assam underwent a special revision instead of SIR due to legal considerations.

For the first time, political parties will receive readable copies of draft and final electoral rolls in both printed and digital formats. Candidates contesting elections in the five poll-bound states will also be provided copies, while electoral registration officers will make the rolls available for purchase to other interested persons before the elections.

The 403-member Uttar Pradesh Assembly's term ends on May 22, 2027. The terms of the assemblies in Manipur, Goa, Punjab and Uttarakhand expire on different dates in March 2027.

Under the Representation of the People Act, 1950, the commission can conduct elections earlier than six months before an assembly's term expires.

SC rules

against a Madras High Court judgment that had struck down a state government order permitting eligible converts from specified communities to seek Muslim Backward Class certificates.

In its 40-page order, the court said conversion to a non-Hindu social order does not automatically confer membership of any particular notified Backward Class community. It also ruled that a private religious body cannot conclusively determine a person's entitlement to statutory reservation benefits.

"We are of the view that the impugned G.O. (government order) cannot be sustained and has rightly been quashed by the High Court," the bench said, adding that the order created an artificial route for a person to move from a previously recognised backward social group into a notified Muslim Backward Class without establishing the necessary social and legal connection.

The court also referred to paragraph 3 of the Constitution (Scheduled Castes) Order, 1950, under which a person professing a religion other than Hinduism, Sikhism or Buddhism cannot be recognised as a member of a Scheduled Caste. It held that conversion to a religion outside those specified removes the Scheduled Caste status attached to a person's previous caste identity. Such antecedent membership, it said, cannot by itself support a claim to affirmative action under Article 16(4) of the Constitution.

The bench clarified that community certificates recognise an existing status rather than create or confer it. It also addressed cases of reconversion to Hinduism, saying eligibility for reservation cannot be decided solely on the basis of a person's earlier caste status. The competent authority must independently examine whether the original caste or social identity has genuinely revived and whether the person meets the applicable constitutional and legal requirements.

The case arose from a petition filed by Sameer Ahamed, who converted from Hinduism to Islam in 2015, with the conversion notified through a Gazette notification in 2016. He later married according to Islamic rites and sought a certificate recognising him as belonging to the Muslim Lebbai community to obtain reservation benefits.

The Tamil Nadu government defended its March 9, 2024, government order, arguing that it aimed to ensure that people from socially and educationally backward communities were not deprived of reservation benefits solely because they converted to Islam. Citing a report by the Tamil Nadu Backward Classes Commission, the state said it could issue Muslim Backward Class certificates to eligible converts from Backward Classes, Most Backward Classes, denotified communities and Scheduled Castes.

On June 25, the Madras High Court declared the order unconstitutional, ruling that conversion alone could not establish membership of a specific notified Muslim Backward Class community. The Supreme Court had reserved its verdict on the state's appeal on August 7.

Upholding the high court's decision, the bench concluded that a person's former caste or community status cannot automatically be transferred to a different notified community following conversion.

Caller name display must

The circular clarified that implementing the service on older 2G and 3G networks, as well as public switched telephone networks, would be considered separately after further examination.

Under the proposed system, recipients will see the name saved in their contact list, followed by the name identified by the telecom operator with which the caller is registered. Domestic calls will display the caller's identity, while calls originating overseas will be marked as international calls.

For bulk business connections, the displayed name can be a registered trademark belonging to the user or a trade name recorded on the goods and services portal.

Telecom operators must collect the preferred names of new bulk subscribers through their application forms, subscriber records and supporting documents. Existing subscribers will be allowed to apply to update their preferred names, subject to examination and verification by the originating telecom operator.

However, the names of subscribers who have opted for Calling Line Identification Restriction (CLIR), which prevents their identities from being displayed under existing rules, will remain hidden under CNAP.

Modi inaugurates five key projs worth Rs 3,350 crore in Ladakh

New airport terminal, road to strengthen Ladakh connectivity...

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi/Leh, October 15





L-G VINAI KUMAR SAXENA SAID THE PROJECTS WOULD BE MILESTONES IN LADAKH'S DEVELOPMENT, STRENGTHENING CONNECTIVITY, WATER SECURITY...

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday virtually inaugurated five development projects worth around Rs 3,350 crore in Ladakh, covering airport infrastructure, strategic road connectivity, power supply, water conservation and heritage preservation, while stressing that special attention was being given to the Union Territory's youth.

"Our special focus is on the new generation of Ladakh. The youth should receive good education, get opportunities to learn new technology, and not depend on other cities," Modi said, adding that a major centre of excellence was being established in Leh. Proposals to set up satellite campuses of IIT Jammu and IIM Jammu were also being advanced to improve access to higher education, research and skill development in the region.

The projects include a Rs 640-crore passenger terminal at Kushok Bakula Rimpochee Airport in Leh, spread over 23,800 square metres and designed to handle 35 lakh passengers annually. Equipped with geothermal heating, the terminal is India's first airport terminal with the facility and aims to improve energy efficiency while reducing its carbon footprint.

Modi said the modern infrastructure would also give a boost to tourism.

He also dedicated the 298-km Nimmu-Padum-Darcha Road, built by the Border Roads Organisation (BRO), connecting Leh with Darcha in Himachal Pradesh through the remote Zanskar Valley. Traversing the high-altitude Shinkun La Pass, the road provides an alternative route to Ladakh alongside the Srinagar-Leh and Manali-Leh highways, strengthening military logistics and improving access to healthcare, education and markets.

Modi said a journey that earlier took around 12 hours could now be completed in three.

The other projects include the 9 MW Hanu small hydroelectric project and the 66 kV double-circuit Dah-Hanu-Khaltsi transmission line, aimed at improving power supply and strengthening the region's electricity network.

The Prime Minister also inaugurated India's first Petroglyph Conservation Park at Sindhu Ghat in Leh to preserve prehistoric rock carvings depicting wildlife, human figures and symbolic representations.

Under Project Him Sarovar, 40 water bodies developed across 40 villages were inaugurated to conserve water and address seasonal shortages faced by farmers during sowing.

The initiative seeks to store water when available and ensure its supply when required, supporting irrigation and long-term water security.

Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena said the projects would be milestones in Ladakh's development, strengthening connectivity, water security, power supply and cultural heritage preservation.

"Five new infrastructure projects would prove to be milestones in Ladakh's development, strengthening connectivity, water security, power supply and preservation of cultural heritage," Saxena said.

He said Ladakh had witnessed significant improvements in infrastructure and living standards since becoming a Union Territory in 2019. Highlighting agricultural progress, he said more than 11,000 greenhouses now enabled farmers to grow vegetables locally and supply them to defence forces through cooperatives.

Saxena also highlighted progress in road connectivity, drinking water supply and support for Pashmina herders, and said the completion of the Zojila Tunnel would address a major challenge posed by winter isolation. He urged Modi to inaugurate the tunnel once completed.

Imran Khan told to leave India by Oct 28; actor to approach HC

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, October 15



A notice by Mumbai Police asking Bollywood actor Imran Khan, a US citizen, to leave the country by October 28 for participating in demonstrations against CEC Gyanesh Kumar has triggered a controversy, with the filmstar deciding to move the Bombay High Court and opposition parties terming the decision as "dictatorial".

Khan, an Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) cardholder who has acted in several Bollywood films including 'I Hate Luv Storys' (2010) and 'Mere Brother Ki Dulhan' (2011), was served the notice by the Foreigners Regional Registration Office (FRRO) for allegedly violating provisions of the Immigration and Foreigners Act.

Khan, nephew of Bollywood superstar Aamir Khan, participated in an agitation at Mumbai's August Kranti Maidan on October 10, where protesters demanded the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. Police had briefly detained Khan during the demonstration.

A police official said a formal notice instructing Khan to leave the country by October 28 was served on the 43-year-old actor and further administrative procedures were on.

"Imran Khan holds foreign citizenship and is not an Indian national. Under relevant provisions of the Foreigners/Immigration Act, foreign nationals are prohibited from participating in political protests or political activities on Indian soil," a police official said.

Following the agitation last week, a video surfaced showing the actor responding to a reporter's query about his participation in the protest as he was being escorted to a police vehicle. "I have no demands. I am not part of any organisation," he had said.

BJP leader Kirit Somaiya, known for making hardline speeches, had urged Mumbai police to act against Khan for joining a protest here in support of the Cockroach Janta Party despite being a "foreign citizen" and sought clarity on whether the actor could participate in such agitations. The BJP leader on Thursday welcomed the police action against the actor and demanded that others involved in similar activities also be deported.

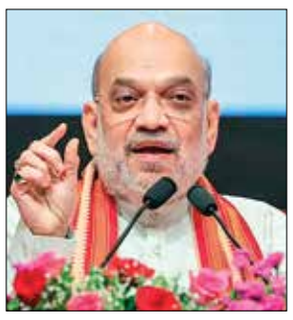
Meanwhile, the actor is likely to approach the Bombay High Court on Friday or Monday through his advocate Zulfiquar Memon, challenging the notice.

According to the draft plea, no provision of law or rule prohibits an OCI cardholder from participating in a peaceful protest.

Opposition leaders criticised the notice against actor Imran Khan, with Congress calling it dictatorial and allies defending his right to protest, while BJP's Somaiya sought deportation.

Shah vows rehabilitation of Naxal violence victims

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, October 15



HIGHLIGHTING REHABILITATION EFFORTS, HE SAID 8,526 NAXAL CADRES HAD SURRENDERED. 455 HAD BEEN PROVIDED EMPLOYMENT OPPORTUNITIES...

Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Thursday said the government's focus after eliminating Naxalism would be on healing the wounds of people maimed by decades of violence and ensuring they lead lives of dignity.

Addressing a function to distribute assistive devices to persons with disabilities, including those affected by Naxal violence, Shah said the Centre would support the Chhattisgarh government in rehabilitating those affected by the conflict.

The programme, organised as part of the ongoing 'Seva Sankalp Abhiyan', marked the second phase of the Divyang Seva Camp, held to commemorate 25 years of Prime Minister Narendra Modi's public leadership, from his tenure as Gujarat Chief Minister to his time as Prime Minister.

The assistive device distribution drive began in Jagdalpur on October 5 and concluded on October 7. More than 3,600 persons with disabilities, including over 1,570 from Bastar, received devices such as artificial limbs, wheelchairs, tricycles, crutches, hearing aids and smart sticks.

Shah said Naxals had crossed all limits by injuring innocent people through improvised explosive device (IED) blasts to pursue narrow political motives, calling such acts a crime against humanity.

Highlighting rehabilitation efforts, he said 8,526 Naxal cadres had surrendered. Of these, 455 had been provided employment opportunities, 129 had received land and 4,014 beneficiaries had been allotted houses under the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana.

The Home Minister also highlighted initiatives such as the Bastar Olympics, Bastar Pandum and Niyad Nellanar, which aim to improve infrastructure, promote development and preserve tribal culture.

Announcing a further step towards strengthening public services, Shah said more than 200 of the over 500 security camps established in the region would be converted into Shaheed Veer Gundadhur Seva Dera. Officials at these centres would work to expand access to essential amenities for the people of Bastar.

ANKITA BHANDARI MURDER CASE

Rahul Gandhi seeks President Murmu's intervention on Gautam's appointment; parents threaten nationwide stir

New Delhi, October 15

The demand for the removal of Dushyant Kumar Gautam as Sikkim Governor intensified on Thursday, with the Congress urging President Droupadi Murmu to reconsider his appointment until the CBI completes its probe into the Ankita Bhandari murder case. Ankita's parents warned of a nationwide protest if the government failed to act within 24 hours.

The parents, who began a sit-in at India Gate on Wednesday, were detained early Thursday and released after about an hour. Ankita's father said his wife fell ill after hearing about Gautam's appointment, while his wife broke down, expressing anguish over their daughter's quest for justice.



Mother of the deceased victim Ankita Bhandari

Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi wrote to Murmu, urging her to ask the government to reconsider its advice to appoint Gautam. Calling the President his "last resort", Gandhi argued that a Governor's constitutional immunity from criminal proceedings could place Gautam beyond the reach of prosecution, rendering the ongoing inquiry ineffective.

In Uttarakhand, the Congress staged a protest outside Lok Bhawan in Dehradun. Around 50 people, including former chief minister Harish Rawat and state Congress president Ganesh Godiyal, were detained, though the party managed to submit its memorandum.

Dhami accused Congress of politicising the case, while Kharge condemned the detentions. Bhayana said Ankita's parents wanted to keep their protest non-political. PTI

Akhilesh alleges 19L fake voters

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, October 15

Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav on Thursday accused the BJP of manipulating electoral rolls with the alleged support of the Election Commission and the administration, claiming that 19 lakh fake voters had been identified.

Addressing a press conference in Lucknow, Yadav alleged that bogus voters were being registered, opposition supporters' names deleted, EVMs manipulated and vote counting tampered with. He cited alleged irregularities in Sarojini Nagar and Sultanpur, and claimed that Loni and Sahibabad had reported 15,000 and 13,000 fake voters, respectively.

The allegations could not be independently verified. The Election Commission and BJP's responses were not immediately available.

SETS OUT POLITICAL VISION

Former IAS officer Divya Mittal announces new political party, to contest UP polls in '27

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, October 15

'PARTY AIMS TO BUILD A SYSTEM IN WHICH GOVT WORKS IN ACCORDANCE WITH PEOPLE'S NEEDS'

In a video message, Mittal said the problem was not a lack of politics but the failure to listen to people's concerns. She said public participation, need-based decision-making and accountability would form the foundation of her political approach.

Recalling her earlier announcement about entering politics, Mittal said she had shared a phone number to connect with people but received such a large volume of messages that WhatsApp blocked the number. She said she had not anticipated such a response and apologised for the inconvenience caused by her inability to make adequate arrangements to handle the messages.

Describing the response, Mittal said she felt as though she was standing with a small lamp in front of the sun when all she needed to do was open a window. Through the analogy, she sought to convey her experience of the public response to her political plans.

Three commitments at the core of Janneeti Bharat

Mittal outlined three key commitments that would guide the new party. First, public participation would be central to policymaking. Second, decisions would be based on people's needs rather than their identity. Third, the government would be accountable to the public for its actions, with accountability serving as the basis for corrective measures.

She said the party aimed to build a system in which the government worked in accordance with people's needs and expectations.

With the announcement, Mittal has formally outlined her political plans ahead of the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections. The party's performance and organisational reach will depend on how it translates its stated principles into a political programme and builds a presence across the state.

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice No. : JHS-N-W-82-26 Date : 13.10.2026

E-Tendering Notice

Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/ Jhansi, DRM's office, Jhansi, for and on behalf of President of India invite open Tender through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following works.

E-Tender No. : JHS-N-W-82-26	Approx Cost : Rs. 31648277.31
Description of work : Provision of Aspiration system for balance stations as per RDSO specification no. RDSO/ SPN/ 217/ 2021 ver. 3.1 or latest over Jhansi Division.	
Earnest Money : Rs. 633000/-	Cost of Tender Form : Nil.
Opening of tender : 05.11.2026 Time 15:00	
Completion period from issue of letter of acceptance : 12 Months	

• Tender online can be submitted upto 15:00 hrs on 05.11.2026. • For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in

(NORTH CENTRAL RLY / JHANSI DIVISION-S AND T) 2344/26 (AS)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

The Divisional Railway Manager (Engg.)/ E.C. Railway/Samastipur for and on behalf of the President of India invites Open Tender from experienced and financially capable tenderers for the following works in e-Tendering mode of IREPS web portal of Indian Railways :-

Sl. No.: 1, Tender Notice No: TC-149-2026-SPJ, Name of Work: Balance Works of Civil Engg. Works cost only for Ten numbers S & T IPS/RTU Building provision at mid section in connection with the work "Provision of RTU with networking & reliable Power Supply at mid section interlocked LC gates in DBG, SHC section of division"., Tender Value (in Rs.) : 4256239.34, Earnest Money (in Rs.) : 85100.00, Completion period of the work: 06 Months.

Sl. No.: 2, Tender Notice No: TC-150-2026-SPJ, Name of Work: Balance work at Darbhanga-Store room for LHB items and testing & repairing lab for electronic items of size 20'x120', Tender Value (in Rs.) : 8241572.59, Earnest Money (in Rs.) : 164800.00, Completion period of the work:04 Months

1. Last Date & time for receiving of Tender in E-Tender mode on IREPS web portal: 02/11/2026 upto 12.00 hours.
2. Opening Date & time for E-Tender: 02/11/2026 after 12.00 hours.
3. Website particulars where complete details of tender & tender document can be seen on Website:www.ireps.gov.in.

Amendments / modifications if any shall not be published in the newspapers but the same shall be uploaded in the website.

Sr. Divisional Engineer / Co-ord
E.C.Railway/Samastipur

PR/1105/SPJ/ENGG/T/26-27/52

कार्यालय, जिला परिषद, राँची
(अभियंत्रण शाखा)

अति अल्पकालीन ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

टेन्डर रिफ्रेन्स नम्बर–DOPR/DE/Ranchi/27/2026-27

क्र0	योजना का नाम	स्वीकृत राशि (रुपये में)	अग्रधन की राशि	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
1	2	3	4	5	6
01	Main Building & Common Area at SIRD Hehal, Ranchi (Renovation)	2,43,53,000.00	4,90,000.00	10,000.00	18 माह

नोट :–केवल ई–टेण्डर ही स्वीकार होगें।
1. अधिकजानकारी के लिए बेबसाईट jharkhandtenders.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।
2. बेबसाईट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि–23.10.2026
3. ई–निविदा की प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय–24.10.2026 से 30.10.2026 अपराह्न 5.00 बजे तक।
4. **निविदा खोलने की तिथि–31.10.2026 को 4.00 बजे अपराह्न।**
5. निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता–जिला अभियंता, जिला परिषद, राँची।
ई–निविदा प्रकोष्ट का दुरभाषनं0–7903003903
6. परिमाण विपत्र की राशि घट बढ़ सकती है तदनुसार अग्रधन की राशि देय होगी।
7. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रधन की राशि का ई–भुगतान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रधन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बंद कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाब देही आपकी होगी।
8. Form of Bid एवं Bill of Quauntity में दर भिन्न रहने पर संबंधित निविदादाता का निविदा अमान्य समझा जाएगा।
9. **निविदा डबल बीड प्रद्वति से होगा।**
10. **इस निविदा में जिला परिषद, राँची में निबंधित समुचित श्रेणी के संवेदक ही भागलेगें।**
11. **जिन संवेदक का कार्य जिला परिषद, राँची में चल रहा है या लंबित है, वे संवेदक इस निविदा में भाग नहीं लेगें, उनकी निविदा अमान्य कर दी जाएगी।**

PR 391859 (Panchayati Raj) 26-27 (D)

जिला अभियंता,
जिला परिषद, राँची।

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA
PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
PUBLIC WORKS DIVISION NO. 1, NAGPUR
INVITATION FOR TENDER
Email: div Luagpur.ect@mahapwd.gov.m
E-Tender Notice No. S/35/2026-2027

Online Item Rato o-tender Preseribed form are Invited by the Executive Engineer, P.W. Division No. 1. Nagpur (Tol Phone No. 2565449) on Behalf of Governor of Maharashtra for following work from Experienced & shop establishment certiflente holders. The name of work, estimated cost, time limit for completion ete, as are under.

Sr No.	Name of work	Estt. cost (Rs. in lakhs)	Estt. cost (Rs. in lakhs)
1	Hire charges of 42" Colour T.V. & LCD with Remote control and setup box full all channel Recharge with 24x 7 Techinical Support and required no. of service Manpower During entire RAC-2026 at MLA hostel, Nagpur	48.48	590.00
2	Hire charges of 42", 55" & 65" colour T.V. & LCD with Remote control and setup Box full all channel Recharge with 24x7 Techical support and required no, of service Manpower During entire RAC 2026 at Ravibhavan	81.82	1180,00

1. Detailed Tender Notice can be soon on web site **https://mahatenders.gov.in**
2. Detailed Tender Notice can be seen on the Notice Board in the office of the undersigned.
3. Right to reject any or all the tenders without assigning any reason thereof is reserved with the undersigned.
4. In this Tender Notice, Tender Downloading. Tender Opening etc. information available on web site.

Outward No. 9357 Date 13 OCT 2026

Executive Engineer
P.W. Division No. 1
Nagpur

Dgipr/2026-27/3273

COMM, ANTI-SUBMARINE WARFARE IN FOCUS

Def Min signs Rs 4,106-cr deals to boost IAF, Navy's capabilities

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15



A Anbarasu, Additional Secretary and Director General (Acquisition) and others during the pact signing programmes

The Ministry of Defence, on Thursday, entered into contracts valued at around Rs 4,106 crore for augmenting the secure communication network of the Indian Air Force and also upgrading the anti-submarine warfare capability of the Indian Navy in order to give a big boost to indigenously manufactured defence equipment.

These contracts pertain to the procurement of the GSAT-7C communication satellite by the Indian Air Force and Varunastra heavy-weight torpedoes by the Indian Navy, which are priced at Rs 2,563 crore and Rs 1,543 crore, respectively. These contracts were inked with New Space India Limited, Bengaluru, and Bharat Dynamics Limited, Hyderabad, in the presence of A Anbarasu, Additional Secretary and Director General (Acquisition).

As a locally produced satellite, GSAT-7C will enable seamless and robust communication for Indian Air Force assets, increasing their coordination and efficiency. The use of the special communication satellite would be important in improving the efficiency of military communications, which is crucial in coordinating air operations in the complex battlespace environment.

Communication satellites have become a strategic need for the Indian military forces, due to the nature of the modern battlefield that is characterised by network-centric operations. In addition to this, modern warfare is all about real-time information. Due to the presence of security threats along the borders with China and Pakistan and the entire Indian Ocean region, the use of a reliable communication satellite is very important.

As opposed to traditional forms of communication networks, satellite technology can ease communication between soldiers posted in distant Himalayan areas, ships working out in distant oceans, and planes and command centres coordinating their work within multiple theatres.

On the contrary, the Varunastra heavy torpedo, created at the Naval Science and Technology Laboratory, is an indigenous, submarine-hunting torpedo with manoeuvring features. The torpedo will enable the Navy to detect and attack hostile submarines from a distance.

HIGHLIGHTS

- The contracts pertain to the procurement of the GSAT-7C communication satellite by the IAF and Varunastra heavy-weight torpedoes by the Navy
- These contracts were inked with New Space India Limited, Bengaluru, and Bharat Dynamics Limited, Hyderabad, in the presence of A Anbarasu, Additional Secretary and Director General (Acquisition)

Activist's murder: No one will be spared, says CM Mann

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, October 15

Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Thursday termed the murder of anti-drug activist Parvinder Singh, alias Jhota, as tragic and asserted that no one will be spared for the crime.

He also hit out at opposition parties for playing politics over the murder to serve their vested interests.

Condemning the tragic incident in Mansa, the Chief Minister said, "The incident is extremely tragic, and strict action will be taken against everyone responsible. No one involved will be spared."

"If anyone was involved in planning or conspiring behind the incident, in addition to those directly responsible, that person will also be brought within the ambit of the law and face stringent action," he asserted.

"It is unfortunate that opposition parties are playing politics over the dead bodies and using this tragedy to serve their vested interests. Our priority is to ensure strict action against everyone responsible and uphold the rule of law," Mann said.

Jhota, known for raising his voice against drug abuse and the illegal sale of addictive substances at chemist shops, was shot dead in a busy market in Punjab's Mansa district on Tuesday.

Punjab 'bandh' over activist's murder evokes mixed response

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, October 15



A woman activist shouts slogans during a 'Punjab Bandh' protest in Amritsar, Thursday PTI

A state-wide bandh called over the murder of anti-drug activist Parvinder Singh Jhota in Mansa evoked a mixed response in Punjab on Thursday, with markets and educational institutions remaining shut and protesters blocking roads at several places, disrupting traffic and bus services.

The shutdown was called by Jhota's family from 6 am to 5 pm, with support from the Congress, BJP, Akali Dal, Akali Dal Waris Punjab De, the Samyukta Kisan Morcha and other farmer and employee organisations. Emergency services remained operational.

Jhota was shot dead inside a medical store in a busy Mansa marketplace on Tuesday after allegedly confronting its owner, Ashwani Kumar, over the sale of addictive drugs. Kumar was taken into custody from Salasar in Rajasthan.

The family has refused to perform Jhota's last rites until justice is delivered. A joint action committee formed after the killing has demanded the resignations of Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann and DGP Gaurav Yadav, the removal of senior Mansa police officials and a CBI probe.

Shops remained closed in several districts, including Amritsar, Hoshiarpur, Jalandhar, Moga, Patiala, Sangrur and Ferozepur. Private schools in several areas also declared holidays. Toll plazas at some locations waived fees, while road blockades forced traffic diversions and affected bus services.

Saini seeks strong ties with Sweden

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, Oct 15



Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini attended the India-Sweden Innovation Day 2026 in Sweden as Chief Guest, calling for stronger cooperation between the two countries in innovation, trade and industry.

Saini said the event offered an opportunity to advance the shared commitment to innovation under the India-Sweden 2035 vision. He thanked the organisers for making Haryana a State Partner in this year's programme.

He said the bilateral trade had risen from USD 2.86 billion in 2016 to USD 7.75 billion in 2025. Highlighting Swedish investments in Haryana, Saini cited IKEA's Rs 3,500-crore integrated project in Gurugram, a Carl-Gustaf manufacturing facility being established at MET City in Jhajjar, and ABB's Faridabad unit, operational since 1951.

He invited dignitaries to the Happening Haryana Global Investors Summit 2027 and the International Gita Mahotsav in Kurukshetra. Swedish Minister Benjamin Dousa, Haryana Cabinet Minister Vipul Goel and Indian Ambassador Anurag Bhushan attended the event.

Briefs

Pune: IT professional 'ends life'

PUNE: A 22-year-old IT professional allegedly died by suicide in Kharadi area of Pune with his family suspecting that he was being harassed by cyber fraudsters in a digital arrest scam, police said on Thursday. The man jumped to his death from a building on October 1. He had been receiving calls from a suspected scamster, an official said. No suicide note was found.

UP: Fake currency racket busted

MUZAFFARNAGAR: A gang allegedly involved in printing and circulating counterfeit currency was busted here on Thursday, with fake notes having a face value of over Rs 5 lakh seized, police said. Three accused, identified as Shubham, Mahendra and Tinu, were arrested.

Drugs worth Rs 57.5 crore seized, 2 held

GUWAHATI: Assam Police have seized Yaba tablets worth Rs 57.5 crore and arrested two persons in Cachar district, Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma said on Thursday. In a social media post, he said police seized 2.3 lakh Yaba tablets from a truck during an operation. Police have initiated necessary legal action in this regard.

Seth calls for coordinated efforts for NCC expansion



MPOST BUREAU
Guwahati, October 15

Union Minister of State for Defence Sanjay Seth on Thursday called for time-bound and coordinated efforts by the Centre and state governments to expand the National Cadet Corps (NCC), stressing its role in developing disciplined, skilled and responsible youth.

Addressing the Special Joint State Representatives and Additional Director General's Conference 2026 under the NCC's North Eastern Region Directorate, Seth urged greater participation of girls to prepare them for future leadership roles. The meeting covered the eight northeastern states and West Bengal.

He said NCC expansion was a priority for the Narendra Modi government and stressed that the objective should be to provide meaningful opportunities for character building and nation-building, rather than merely increasing enrolment.

Seth called on state governments to address manpower shortages and provide the necessary administrative and financial support. He particularly referred to budgetary requirements in West Bengal and expressed confidence that the new state government would extend the required assistance.

Punjab not to face electricity shortage: CM

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 15

Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Thursday said Punjab would face no power shortage as the Centre has assured uninterrupted power and coal supplies.

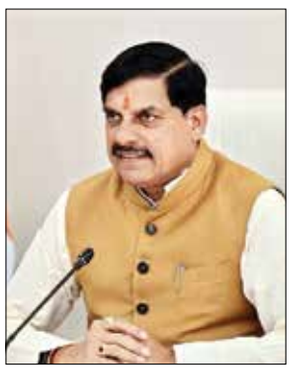
He made the claim after meeting with Union Power Minister Manohar Lal Khattar here.

Emphasising that Punjab is supplying 180 lakh metric tonnes (LMT) of rice to the central pool this year, the chief minister stressed that reliable electricity is essential for the state to sustain its contribution to the nation's food reserves.

Mann also raised concerns over repeated NGT notices concerning the Shahpur Kandi Dam and said the state government is in touch with Coal India and the Jharkhand government to ensure uninterrupted coal supplies.

MP to set up state-owned company for economic corridor development

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA
Bhopal, October 15



Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav on Thursday announced that the state Cabinet had approved the formation of a wholly state-owned company to develop the Jabalpur-Indore Economic Corridor and selected industrial and economic hubs along the route.

Addressing a press conference after the Cabinet meeting, Yadav said the council of ministers had also cleared proposals worth around Rs 27,050 crore, including the implementation of the Bhavantar Bhugtan Yojana to ensure minimum support price (MSP) benefits for soybean farmers during the 2026 kharif season.

The Jabalpur-Indore Economic Corridor Development Company Ltd will be established as a special purpose vehicle (SPV), with an initial paid-up capital of Rs 100 crore. It will oversee the integrated development of industrial parks, food and agro-processing parks, logistics facilities, technology and IT parks, and global capability centres.

The company will also facilitate land management, zoning, master planning and the development of internal and common infrastructure within designated economic hubs. However, construction of the main road or corridor will remain outside its mandate.

Yadav said the Cabinet had approved the Bhavantar scheme under the Centre's PM-AASHA. Registered soybean growers will be eligible for compensation based on the minimum support price, actual sale price and the declared model rate. Payments will be transferred directly to eligible farmers' bank accounts.

The CM said the Cabinet had also sanctioned Rs 3,076.37 crore for the continuation of four irrigation projects in Burhanpur, Raisen, Mandsaur and Singrauli. Another Rs 2,875.20 crore was approved for the construction and expansion of government schools, hostels, libraries and residential sports facilities.

Additionally, Rs 241.88 crore was sanctioned for transportation facilities for students of 94 Sandeepani schools.

The Cabinet also approved 24 new posts for district-level Women and Child Development offices in the newly formed districts of Niwari, Mauganj, Pandhurna and Maihar, Yadav informed reporters.

National Day to commemorate colonialism's victims sought

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15

The Museum of British Colonialism (MBC) has launched a campaign seeking a National Day of Commemoration for the Victims of Colonialism, aiming to highlight the human cost of colonial rule often overshadowed by celebrations of independence.

At its peak in 1913, the British Empire controlled nearly a quarter of the world's landmass and governed 410 million people. In India, almost two centuries of colonial rule brought economic exploitation, disrupted livelihoods and facilitated the transfer of wealth, precious jewels and historical artefacts to Britain, the museum said.

The colonial legacy also included famine, social turmoil and communal tensions. The human cost was particularly evident during the Partition of 1947, which accompanied independence with mass migration, divided families and widespread bloodshed.

The museum also highlighted the British policy of "divide and rule", citing an 1859 statement by Lord Elphinstone, then Governor of Bombay: "Divide et impera was the old Roman maxim: it should be ours."

Chandini Jaswal, India representative of MBC, described the colonial legacy as an ongoing process of adaptation rather than a complete break with the past.

The proposed commemorative day aims to remember those killed during colonial rule, people who lost family members, and communities deprived of their land and livelihoods. It also seeks to preserve their experiences for future generations.

Snow blankets hills, rain disrupts normal life in plains

Southwest monsoon withdraws from entire country: India Meteorological Department

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 15



Houses blanketed in a layer of fresh snow in Keylong, Himachal Pradesh, on Thursday PTI

Fresh snowfall blanketed the higher reaches of northern India on Thursday, forcing the closure of several roads, while heavy rain and gusty winds disrupted normal life in the plains.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) also announced the withdrawal of the southwest monsoon from the entire country as activity under the northeast monsoon continued in parts of southern India.

In Jammu and Kashmir, the Mughal Road and several other routes were closed for clearance operations. Udhampur recorded the highest rainfall at 59.6 mm, followed by Poonch (39.5 mm), Samba and Shopian (34 mm each), Baramulla (29 mm) and Katra (23.1 mm). Srinagar received 12 mm of rain.

In Himachal Pradesh, snowfall was reported at Shinku La, Baralacha La, Kunzum La, Koksar, Jispa, Keylong and Gondla in Lahaul and Spiti, besides Sural and Sach Pass in Chamba. Sural received three inches of snow, while Sach Pass recorded around one foot. Roads from Rohtang Pass to Sarchu, Darcha to Shinku La and Gramphu to Batal were closed. Police evacuated around 100 vehicles stranded near Gondla. The snowfall has raised hopes of increased tourist arrivals, even as temperatures dropped in Manali and Dharamshala.

Heavy rain in Jammu triggered flashflood-like situations in several areas. In Uttarakhand, rain and cloudy skies prevailed, while thunderstorms were forecast in several districts. A man injured by falling rocks on the Kedarnath trekking route was discharged after preliminary treatment.

The IMD forecast isolated heavy rainfall across parts of south peninsular India until October 21 with the onset of the northeast monsoon. Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, coastal Andhra Pradesh, Rayalaseema, south interior Karnataka and Kerala witnessed monsoon activity.

KEY POINTS

- In J&K, the Mughal Road and several other routes were closed for clearance operations
- In HP, snowfall was reported at Shinku La, Baralacha La, Kunzum La, Koksar, Jispa, Keylong and Gondla in Lahaul and Spiti, besides Sural and Sach Pass in Chamba
- In U'khand, rain and cloudy skies prevailed, while thunderstorms were forecast in several districts

EDITORIAL

Voters Must Come First

The Election Commission's decision to undertake a Special Summary Revision of electoral rolls in 17 states and Union Territories comes at a time when public confidence in the integrity of voter lists is under considerable strain. The exercise, with draft rolls scheduled for publication on November 12 and final lists on January 4, 2027, is administratively routine but politically consequential. An accurate electoral roll is the foundation of representative democracy: it must include every eligible citizen while excluding duplicate, deceased and otherwise ineligible entries. Yet accuracy cannot be pursued through procedures that make registration unnecessarily difficult or expose legitimate voters to arbitrary deletion. The Commission must recognise that public trust depends not merely on the numerical cleanliness of its databases but on the fairness, accessibility and transparency of the process through which those databases are maintained.

The distinction between Special Summary Revision and Special Intensive Revision is important, particularly because the latter has generated controversy over documentation requirements and allegations of wrongful exclusions. The Commission has legitimate reasons to verify electoral records, and political parties cannot reasonably demand that voter lists remain untouched despite demographic changes, migration and deaths. Equally, the constitutional responsibility to conduct free and fair elections demands safeguards against administrative errors. The burden of correcting discrepancies must not fall disproportionately on the elderly, migrant workers, economically disadvantaged citizens or those lacking easy access to official documents. Booth-level verification should be conducted sensitively, with adequate notice and meaningful opportunities for correction. No eligible voter should discover the disappearance of their name only upon reaching a polling station.

Transparency must extend beyond announcing deadlines. The Commission should publish clear explanations of procedures, constituency-level data on additions and deletions, and reasons for rejecting applications. Political parties and independent observers should have opportunities to scrutinise the exercise without compromising voters' privacy. Claims and objections must be resolved through consistent standards, not discretionary interpretations that vary between districts. Digital facilities can speed up registration, but they cannot replace physical assistance for citizens without smartphones, reliable connectivity or digital literacy. Equally important is an appeals mechanism capable of correcting mistakes before the final rolls are published. An election authority earns credibility when it welcomes scrutiny rather than treating every question as an attack on its independence.

The political atmosphere makes restraint essential on all sides. Opposition parties should substantiate allegations of manipulation with evidence instead of turning every administrative correction into a partisan confrontation. The ruling establishment, meanwhile, must avoid dismissing concerns merely because they come from political adversaries. Above all, the Election Commission must demonstrate independence through its conduct: transparent decisions, equal treatment and a willingness to remedy errors promptly. Electoral rolls are not ordinary government registers. They determine whether citizens can exercise the most fundamental instrument of democratic accountability. The success of this revision should therefore be measured not by how many names are removed, but by whether every qualified voter can participate without fear of exclusion.

LETTER

letter2editor.mp@gmail.com.

Questionable Selection

Ravichandran Ashwin's criticism of Kuldeep Yadav's exclusion raises serious questions about India's team selection. Dropping a proven wicket-taking spinner despite favourable conditions reflects questionable planning. Team management must prioritise performance and match requirements over rigid combinations. Consistent selection and sound judgement are essential for success in international cricket.

RAJIV SEKHAWAT,
MUMBAI

You can also send your comments to The Editor, *Millennium Post*, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

The Decline of Deliberation

Restoring Parliament's authority requires stronger committees, guaranteed Opposition debate time and greater accountability in the legislative process

DEMOCRATIC DISCOURSE



JOHN FELIX RAJ & PRABHAT KUMAR DATTA

JF RAJ IS THE VC, PK DATTA IS AN ADJUNCT PROFESSOR AT ST XAVIER'S UNIVERSITY, KOLKATA



Democracy cannot flourish when parliamentary disruptions replace meaningful debate

The state of global democracy is showing initial signs of stabilisation. According to the latest Global State of Democracy report, following eight consecutive years of decline, the democratic recession has plateaued—with nearly 75 per cent of countries either improving or maintaining their democratic standing. Yet beneath this surface stability lies profound volatility.

From "Gen Z" uprisings demanding government accountability across Asia and Sub-Saharan Africa to the global rise of ethnic nationalism, populism, and civil conflict, modern governance faces unprecedented strain. As philosopher Jürgen Habermas observed, these crises often stem from the "political neglect and exclusion by regimes purporting to be democratic." To counter this erosion, revitalising deliberative democracy is urgent to ensure depth, inclusion, and accountability across every sphere of public life.

Improving the Quality of Democracy

At the heart of any true democracy lies the quality of its parliamentary deliberation. The health of a republic depends on how effectively elected representatives articulate the needs, aspirations, and grievances of their constituents.

India stands out as both the world's largest democracy and one of its most resilient. Historically, many Western democratic experiments proved far more fragile: Germany's Weimar Republic and France's Fourth Republic crumbled in short order, while full democratic suffrage in the UK was achieved only in 1928. Spain, Portugal, and Greece developed full democratic frameworks much later in the 20th century. India's democratic longevity remains a remarkable testament to its institutional foundations.

A Grand Tradition of Public Reasoning

Democracy in India is not a foreign import; it is rooted in a rich historical tradition. Ancient India was home to several *Gana-Sanghas* (republics), and even within monarchical systems, public consultation was highly valued. Kautilya's ancient treatise, the *Arthashastra,* explicitly advised: "When there is an extraordinary matter, the Ministers and the Council of Ministers should be called together" to deliberate and resolve crisis situations.

In modern India—a multilingual, multicultural, and multi-religious nation—Parliament serves as the ultimate national assembly. While elections grant Parliament democratic legitimacy, robust floor debates allow MPs to pool diverse perspectives, challenge policy, and reflect a diverse population.

The Rise of Disruptions and Tactical Stallings

Despite this rich legacy, the quality of Indian parliamentary debate has suffered a steep decline. Recurrent disruptions, forced adjournments, and opposition walkouts have increasingly crippled normal legislative business.

> WHILE DISRUPTION IS USED AS A PROTEST TACTIC, ITS PRIMARY BENEFICIARY IS NOT THE OPPOSITION—IT IS THE EXECUTIVE

- **Lost Time and Public Money:** Frequent disruptions rob MPs of Question Hour—the primary tool for executive accountability—and limit opportunities to raise pressing public concerns. In a recent monsoon session, over 7,000 minutes of parliamentary time were lost. With the Lok Sabha costing approximately ₹2.5 lakh per minute to operate, this translates to an estimated loss of ₹175 crore to the public exchequer.
- **The Shift Away from Committees:** Scrutiny via Joint Parliamentary Committees (JPCs) has dropped precipitously—falling from 60-70 per cent of bills referred during the 14th and 15th Lok Sabhas to just 16-25 per cent in the 16th and 17th Lok Sabhas.
- **Diminished Productivity:** During a recent monsoon session, the Lok Sabha functioned for only 15 per cent of its scheduled time (17.5 hours), while the Rajya Sabha operated at 33 per cent (37.4 hours), making it one of the least productive sessions in a decade. Crucially, despite these truncated hours, 12 major bills were passed with virtually no floor debate.

Ironically, while disruption is used as a protest tactic, its primary beneficiary is not the Opposition—it is the Executive. When parliamentary debates stall, the executive branch bypasses scrutiny and passes legislation without opposition pushback, concentrating power in ways fundamentally at odds with a parliamentary system.

The Erosion of Financial and Legislative Scrutiny

This decline in deliberative quality is starkly evident in budget discussions. In 1990, parliamentary budget debates lasted over 123 hours. By contrast, recent budget discussions wrapped up in a mere 12 hours—with over 75 per cent of budget demands passed without debate and barely 11 per cent of government expenditure receiving meaningful examination. Furthermore, many critical bills are now routinely rushed through the House after less than an hour of discussion.

To put this in perspective, the UK House of Commons sits for approximately 150 days a year, while the US Congress convenes for nearly 260 days. In India, parliamentary sittings have steadily shrunk in duration, leaving far less room for comprehensive lawmaking.

The Way Forward

To restore Parliament to its full deliberative potential, India can draw both from international best practices and its own advisory commission reports:

- **Institutionalise Opposition Business Days:** In the UK Parliament, specific days are reserved exclusively for opposition parties to set the debate agenda. Adopting a similar mechanism in India would reduce floor disruptions by guaranteeing the Opposition a dedicated platform to raise key national issues.
- **Mandatory Committee Referrals:** In systems like the UK, major legislation is routinely referred to Select Committees for detailed clause-by-clause scrutiny and stakeholder consultation. Mandating committee scrutiny for all major bills would ensure legislation is thoroughly vetted before becoming law.
- **Fix a Minimum Calendar of Sittings:** Key domestic bodies—including the National Commission to Review the Working of the Constitution (2002) and a 2008 Rajya Sabha Committee—have recommended mandating a calendar with a minimum of 100 sitting days per year.
- **Strengthen Committee Powers:** As recommended by the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Personnel, Public Grievances, Law and Justice (2018), parliamentary committees must be empowered and given structural weight to enforce executive accountability.

Reclaiming deliberative democracy in Parliament is not merely a matter of parliamentary procedure; it is essential to upholding the constitutional spirit of the Indian Republic.

Views expressed are personal

The Economics of Lasting Infrastructure

India must prioritise durability over initial costs to ensure infrastructure investments deliver lasting economic value

BUILDING BETTER



RAJAMANI KRISHNAMURTI

THE WRITER IS THE PRESIDENT, INDIAN STAINLESS STEEL DEVELOPMENT ASSOCIATION



Lifecycle value is no longer an option but an essential principle of responsible infrastructure development

India's infrastructure buildout is being measured in highways, railways, bridges, airports and urban assets. But the economic value of that investment will ultimately depend on how these assets perform after construction. Spending less at the beginning can have a different economic outcome if it leads to repeated repairs, rehabilitation or premature replacement. Infrastructure material selection therefore needs to move beyond initial price and towards the value delivered over the full life of an asset.

The recent 2026 CII and Nomura Research Institute report, Built to Last, puts this issue into perspective. It estimates that corrosion costs India around 4.3 per cent of GDP, or about ₹14.15 lakh crore in FY25. Infrastructure alone accounts for an estimated ₹1,41,657 crore, representing about 2.9 per cent of the sector's GDP. The report estimates potential maximum savings of ₹49,580 crore in infrastructure through better corrosion reduction. These figures show that corrosion is not simply a maintenance expense. It is an economic burden on infrastructure investment.

The burden becomes more significant as India's infrastructure footprint grows. The report notes that the national highways network reached around 1.46 lakh kilometres in 2025, airports increased from 74 to 157 between 2015 and 2025, and about 25,871 kilometres of railway tracks were added. Every additional asset creates a long-term obligation to maintain performance and ensure safety.

Corrosion needs to be considered at the planning stage because environmental conditions vary sharply across India. Coastal infrastructure faces chloride and salt exposure. High rainfall and humidity can accelerate deterioration. Urban and industrial environments can add pollutants, chemicals and persistent moisture. Bridges and transport infrastructure also face heavy loads and difficult maintenance access. A material or protection system that performs adequately in one setting may not be appropriate in another.

This is where lifecycle costing becomes important. The CII and NRI report shows how a lower initial cost can accumulate into a higher lifecycle cost when repeated maintenance is required. Its analysis gives standard TMT a typical durability range of 40 to 50 years, while galvanised TMT is shown at more than 100 years in the environments considered. For structural steel, multi-coat paint systems are shown with coating lives of 10 to 25 years, while hot dip galvanising is shown at more than 100 years. The comparison shows why initial price alone is incomplete.

> A CII-NRI REPORT ESTIMATES ₹14.15 LAKH CRORE IN CORROSION LOSSES, HIGHLIGHTING THE NEED FOR DURABLE INFRASTRUCTURE

Stainless steel should be part of that wider lifecycle conversation. Its value is strongest where corrosion resistance, durability and low maintenance are particularly important, particularly where future intervention is difficult or failure carries high consequences. The report recognises stainless steel among corrosion protection approaches in global standards for demanding environments. It also records stainless steel reinforcement as a requirement for highway bridges within 15 kilometres of the coastline, illustrating how exposure-specific material decisions can be built into infrastructure practice.

The next step is to make lifecycle thinking more systematic. Life Cycle Cost Analysis should consider material and construction costs along with inspection, maintenance, repair, rehabilitation, replacement and downtime. For a public asset expected to serve for decades, the relevant measure is the total cost of delivering required performance over its service life. The CII and NRI report makes the case for using lifecycle cost analysis to guide major infrastructure design and material decisions.

Standards can help make this shift practical. The CII and NRI report identifies gaps in service life guidance, exposure-specific requirements, repair and acceptance limits and testing methodologies. It recommends clearer service life frameworks and more appropriate testing methods. India should move towards specifications that define durability according to actual environmental and operational conditions.

This requires accountability across the value chain. Designers and consultants influence material selection. Specifiers translate performance requirements into tender documents. Manufacturers must maintain quality. Contractors and installers must ensure correct execution. Inspectors and asset owners must detect deterioration early and maintain the asset through its life.

India has the opportunity to align material science, stronger standards, better testing and preventive maintenance with lifecycle-based procurement. When materials are selected for how long and how reliably they will perform, rather than simply what they cost at the point of purchase, infrastructure investment can deliver greater value for longer. For a country building at this scale, lifecycle value is becoming a basic requirement for responsible infrastructure development.

Views expressed are personal

News at a glance

Hezbollah claims confiscated explosives in Lebanon

BEIRUT: A Hezbollah official acknowledged Thursday that a truck full of explosives seized by Lebanese authorities last week belonged to the militant group and said the explosives were intended for use against Israeli forces in southern Lebanon.

The truck, which was stopped at a checkpoint on the main highway linking Beirut with the eastern Bekaa Valley, was carrying 780 kilograms (1,720 pounds) of explosives, including 250 kilograms (550 pounds) of TNT and 250 kilograms (550 pounds) of C-4 plastic explosives, reports said.

Israel says commercial goods will not enter Gaza

JERUSALEM: Israel said that commercial goods will no longer enter the Gaza Strip, cutting off a key source of food and shelter supply for the war-torn territory as hungry Palestinians face the approach of winter.

COGAT, the Israeli military body that oversees humanitarian affairs in Gaza, announced the suspension of commercial goods in a Wednesday statement. It was not clear whether they made the decision. COGAT said it was relaying a statement from Gaza merchants, a claim Palestinians refuted.

Aden: Six blasts strike near Yemen govt buildings

ADEN: Witnesses in Yemen's port city of Aden said they heard at least six explosions Thursday near the palace used by Yemen's international recognised government.

A security official said at least two of the explosions were on top of the hill near the Maashiq palace, and two others were heard below near the security gate leading up.

Houthi rebels quoted a military official as saying an operation room and a weapons warehouse in the governmental palace were targeted.



Riot police officers detain a hooded protester during clashes near the Ministry of Education in Tirana Tuesday, joining a demonstration organized by the Flamingo protest movement demanding the resignation of PM Edi Rama AP/PTI

Balen Shah picks India for first bilateral foreign trip as Nepal PM

AGENCIES
Kathmandu, October 15

Nepal Prime Minister Balendra Shah (Balen Shah) is preparing to visit India in November.

The three-day visit, expected in the third or fourth week of November, would be his first official bilateral trip abroad, although he travelled to the US in September for the United Nations General Assembly.

From major infrastructure projects to border disputes and flood reconstruction, Balen Shah's India visit is expected to have a packed agenda, reported The Kathmandu Post.

OWNER OF THE SCHOOL ARRESTED

At least 34 children, teacher killed as school roof collapses in Pakistan

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Peshawar, October 15

At least 34 children and a teacher were killed when the roof of a private school collapsed on Thursday in Peshawar, the capital of Pakistan's Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province, hospital authorities and police said.

The incident occurred in Dir Colony in the congested inner city area, Peshawar Capital City Police chief Mian Saeed said. Thirty students were present in classrooms on the upper floor of the Al-Khair School when the roof collapsed, he said.

The owner, who was operating the institution as an education trust, has been arrested, he said, adding that the roof of the three-storey building was poorly constructed.



People gather at a hospital next to the bodies of children, who died in the roof collapse of a private school, in Peshawar on Thursday AP/PTI

Thirty-two children and a teacher were brought dead to the Lady Reading Hospital (LRH) in Peshawar, hospital spokesperson Muhammad Asim told PTI. Two bodies were shifted to Naseerullah Khan Babar Memorial Hospital in the city.

Asim said 20 injured children were also brought to the LRH hospital. Most of them were discharged after first aid. Three critically injured children, who sustained head injuries, had been admitted to the hospital, he added.

An emergency was declared at the hospital to treat the injured, Asim said, adding that all of the children killed or injured in the incident were age 13 or younger.

Peshawar Deputy Commissioner Afaq Wazir said all people trapped beneath the debris have been rescued.

US teen held for plotting mass shooting at Hindu temple in Illinois

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New York, October 15

A teenager was arrested for allegedly plotting to carry out a "mass shooting" at a Hindu place of worship in the US state of Illinois, with investigators recovering a manifesto expressing white supremacist ideology and references to violence against people of Indian descent. Alexandros Paporakis, 19, of Palatine village was arrested on October 11 and charged with making a terrorist threat and unlawful possession of a weapon.

According to investigators, the youth had tried to open fire "potentially targeting" the place of worship in the Aurora city in Illinois, but his gun jammed, forcing him to drive back home, a move that prevented a mass murder.

The specific intended location has not been disclosed by the authorities.

Palatine Police detectives examined electronic communications and a document attributed to Paporakis titled "Why I Fought: A.K.A.: (Aurora Shooter's Manifesto)", which contained "statements expressing white supremacist and extremist ideologies, including references to violence directed toward individuals of South Asian heritage, particularly those of Indian descent". Detectives believe Paporakis may have been planning to carry out the attack on October 11.

"However, the specific intended location has not been confirmed and remains under investigation," police said on Wednesday. The Consulate General of India in Chicago said it appreciated the timely action by law enforcement authorities and was in touch with members of the Indian diaspora while closely monitoring developments.

The arrest comes amid celebrations of Hindu festivals, including Navaratri and Durga Puja, and just two weeks after the Shree Swaminarayan Vadtal Dham Hindu Mandir in Richmond Heights, Ohio, was vandalised.

India flags rising anti-India hate In United States

India on Thursday expressed concern over an alleged plot to carry out a mass shooting at a Hindu temple in Aurora, Illinois, and called on US authorities to take decisive action against hate-motivated violence

The alleged conspiracy was "particularly disturbing" because it included references to violence against Indian origin people, said Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal.

World's oldest shipwreck discovered off coast of Turkey

Prior to it, the world's oldest shipwreck was a wreck off the coast of Dokos, in Greece

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Sydney, October 15

A shipwreck off the coast of Turkiye is the oldest shipwreck in the world, our team of archaeologists believes.

There's little left of the ship itself but based on clues from its cargo -- including pottery vessels -- a research team I was part of has tentatively dated the wreck to around 2700-2400 BCE. That's about 4,500 years ago. Prior to this discovery, the world's oldest shipwreck was a wreck off the coast of Dokos, in Greece, thought to have been from about 4,200 years ago.

Much work remains to be done to finesse the conclusions, and a paper outlining the results is yet to be published in a peer-reviewed journal. Yet the discovery could transform our understanding of ancient Mediterranean connections during the Early Bronze Age. Here, and perhaps even earlier, lie the foundations of extensive trade routes as we know them today.

ASSOCIATE PROFESSOR HAKAN ONIZ OF AKDENIZ UNIVERSITY, ANTALYA, HAS WORKED ALONG THIS COASTLINE FOR DECADES EXCAVATING ANCIENT SHIPWRECKS

Associate Professor Hakan Oniz of Akdeniz University, Antalya, has worked along this coastline for decades excavating ancient shipwrecks.

Acting on clues from local seafarers, Oniz found a shipwreck in shallow waters off Kekova, west of Antalya in Turkiye, in 2024. Earlier this year, he contacted me and asked if I would help date some of the pottery vessels found on this wreck.

As an archaeologist specialising in desert sites, this was a singular experience. New technology, water-logged methods of excavation and laborious conservation techniques were the new normal.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Himanshu @ Salman @ Rancho S/o Raju R/o E-73, A-42, Sanjay Colony, Govind Puri, Delhi-94** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 68/20 U/s 379/411 IPC at PS: Krishna Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Himanshu @ Salman @ Rancho** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Himanshu @ Salman @ Rancho** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Himanshu @ Salman @ Rancho of FIR No. 68/20 U/s 379/411 IPC of PS: Krishna Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 06.01.2027.**

By order
P. Bhargav Rao
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
East District Court No: 03,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/14445/SHD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mahmood @ Mohd. Mamun, S/o Babu Ahmed @ Md Babul R/o Rizwan Ka Makan, near Nafeesha Masjid Sarai Kale Khan, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.319/2025 u/s 317(2)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, P.S. Hazrat Nizamuddin, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mahmood @ Mohd. Mamun** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mahmood @ Mohd. Mamun** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Mahmood @ Mohd. Mamun** of **FIR No.319/2025 u/s 317(2)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, P.S. Hazrat Nizamuddin, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.11.2026.**

By Order,
Sh. Manuj Kaushal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-3, South-East
Room No.512, Saket Court, New Delhi

DP/14789/SE/2026

GOVERNMENT OF HIMACHAL PRADESH
JAL SHAKTI VIBHAG
NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

The Executive Engineer, Jal Shakti Division, Kangra invites online tenders on behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh, from approved eligible contractors for the following works through e-tendering process:-

S/No.	Name of work.	Estimated Cost.	Earnest Money	Time Limit	Cost of Tender Form
1	Name of Work:- Annual repair and maintenance of Sewerage scheme Kangra town in Tehsil and District Kangra(HP). (SH) Operation and maintenance of complete sewer network, manhole Chambers and sewerage treatment plant 1.46 MLD and 0.63 MLD sewer network (Zone-II & III for three years).	2,63,01,578/-	3,38,020/-	3 Years	7000/-

Last date of filling/uploading the tender trough e-tendering 02/11/2026 upto 11.00AM. The tender form and other detailed condition can be obtained from the website www.hptenders.gov.in.

Ro.No 4144/2026-2027

Executive Engineer,
Jal Shakti Division Kangra

Jharkhand Bijli Vitran Nigam Limited
(CIN:U40108JH2013SGC001702)
Regd. Office :Engineering Building, H.E.C., Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004,
Email:-gm.commercial@jbvnl.co.in

e-procurement Notice

NIT No.- 284/PR/JBVNL/2026-27

Jharkhand Bijli Vitran Nigam Limited, Hq. Office at Dhurwa, Ranchi 834004, Jharkhand invites E-tender for bid from eligible Bidders for **Supply of Three Phase four Wire Trivector energy 0.2s Accuracy class 79 nos. 33KV ABT Meter with ABT software along with Installation accessories, and also Installation & Commissioning and System Maintenance of ABT metering system for Five years under O&M Head.**

Sl. No.	Details of Work	
1	33KV ABT Meter with Accessories like metering units and other componenets - ABT Software, for installation at 33KV interface point between JUSNL-JBVNL and DVC - JBVNL (i.e take-off point-Ougoing Structure at 220/132/33KV Grid-Subsation of JUSNL and DVC under Electric Supply Areas Ranchi, Jamshedpur, Dumka, Medininagar, Giridih, Dhanbad, and Hazaribagh . (Supply, Installation, Commissioning and Annual Maintenance of ABT Meters with all Accessories and ABT software)	
2	**Calendar of Events:**	**Date and time**
i	Date of Publication of NIT on website	16.10.2026 at 15:30 hrs
ii	Last date for submission of pre-bid queries along with request for online participation through video conference at Email-gm.commercial@jbvnl.co.in	23.10.2026 till 15:00 hrs
iii	Pre-Bid Meeting Date and Time	27.10.2026 at 12:30 hrs
iv	Last Date/Time for receipt of bids	17.11.2026 till 15:00 hrs
v	Date and Time for Opening of Technical bid	19.11.2026 at 17:00 hrs

1. The tender documents with detailed conditions can be obtained through web site http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in and should upload all relevant documents as mentioned in the tender document only through online e-tender portal/website http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in

स्वहित एवं राष्ट्र हित में ऊर्जा बचावें। कृपया अपनी शिकयतें को टॉल फ्री नं० 1800 345 6570 पर दर्ज करायें।

PR 391928 Jharkhand Bijlee Vitran Nigam Ltd (26-27)_D

Sd/-
General Manager (Comml.)

कार्यालय श्री महाकालेश्वर मंदिर
प्रबंध समिति, उज्जैन
www.shrimahakaleshwar.mp.gov.in
Fax : 0734-2550144/2550563

क्र./महा/स्टोर/2026/3435 उज्जैन दिनांक 15.10.2026

निविदा विज्ञप्ति (सुविधा प्रबंधन एवं मानव संसाधन)

Tender ID- 2026_MMPSU_542247_1

श्री महाकालेश्वर मंदिर प्रबंध समिति द्वारा संचालित विभिन्न इकाइयों में सुविधा प्रबंधन हेतु कर्मचारी प्रदाय करने के लिये संबंधित निविदाकारों से ई-टेण्डर के माध्यम से ऑनलाइन दरें आमंत्रित की जाती हैं :-

कार्य का नाम : श्री महाकालेश्वर मंदिर प्रबंध समिति में (सुविधा प्रबंधन) हेतु।
कार्य की अनुमानित लागत : रु. 25,00,00,000/-
अमानत राशि : रु. 75,00,000 /-
टेण्डर डाक्यूमेन्ट की लागत : रु. 50,000/-
टेण्डर डाक्यूमेंट क्रय करने एवं बिड प्रस्तुत करने की दिनांक ई-टेण्डरिंग पोर्टल **https://mptenders.gov.in** पर Tender ID : 2026_MMPSU_542247_1 देखी जा सकती है। पोर्टल में उल्लेखित दिनांक अनुसार कार्यवाही सुनिश्चित करें।

म.प्र. माध्यम/128616/2026 **उप प्रशासक एवं डिप्टी कलेक्टर**

म.प्र. राज्य पर्यटन विकास निगम मर्या.
पर्यटन भवन, भदभदा रोड, भोपाल-462003
फोन नं. : +91 755-4027100, 2774340, 42, www.mpstdc.com

क्रमांक 500/यांत्रिकी/पविनि/26 दिनांक: 15.10.2026

निविदा सूचना 356/2026_STDC_543642_1

मध्यप्रदेश राज्य पर्यटन विकास निगम भोपाल द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु ऑनलाइन (Online) निविदा प्रपत्र APPENDIX 2.10 पर म.प्र. लोक निर्माण विभाग में उपयुक्त श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से आमंत्रित की जाती है। **कार्य का नाम:-** म.प्र. राज्य पर्यटन विकास निगम की इकाई विण्ड एण्ड वेव्ज भोपाल में 02 कॉटेजेस के रिनोवेशन, इंटीरियर एवं शेष अन्य कार्य। (06 माह)। कार्य की अनुमानित लागत राशि रु. 590.00 लाख

वेबसाइट पर ऑनलाइन भुगतान कर निविदा प्रपत्र (टेण्डर डाक्युमेंट) वेबसाइट के माध्यम से क्रय किये जा सकते है। निविदा प्रपत्र ऑनलाइन क्रय करने की **अंतिम तिथि 30.10.2026 समय सायं 05:00 बजे तक** निर्धारित है। कार्य का विस्तृत विवरण वेबसाइट **https://mptenders.gov.in** पर देखा जा सकता है।

म.प्र. माध्यम/128635/2026 **कार्यपालन यंत्री**

millenniumpost CLASSIFIEDS

CHANGE OF NAME

I, SYED ADEEB ALI, S/o Syed Ajmal Ali R/o 2741, Gali Chandi Wali, Pahari Bhojla, Turkman Gate, Delhi -110006 do hereby declare that in my passport No. E-9313426, my name was wrongly written as Syed Adib Ali and my father's name as Ajmal Ali mentioned incorrect in my old childhood passport. My correct name is SYED ADEEB ALI and my father correct name is SYED AJMAL ALI. That in future I shall be known and called by the the the name SYED ADEEB ALI S/o SYED AJMAL ALI.

I ROHIT CHOUDHARY S/o Sh. VIRENDER SINGH R/O H. No.466, Jat Chowk, Nangloi Village Delhi-110041, do hereby declare. That I am the father of Mr. Daivik Chaudhary due to some unavoidable reasons or by clerical mistake my name is mentioned as ROHIT CHAUDHARY instead of ROHIT CHOUDHARY in your school records. That my actual and correct name is ROHIT CHOUDHARY. That ROHIT CHAUDHARY and ROHIT CHOUDHARY both are same person.

News at a glance

Tata Communications Q2 profit rises 86.29% to ₹341 cr

NEW DELHI: Tata Communications on Thursday reported 86.29 per cent increase in consolidated net profit at Rs 341.03 crore for September quarter FY27. The company had posted a net profit of Rs 183.06 crore in the year-ago period, a regulatory filing said.

Revenue from operations rose 9.6 per cent to Rs 6,687.89 crore in Q2 FY27 against Rs 6,099.75 crore in Q2 FY26. When compared to the previous June quarter, the profit more than doubled and revenue was up by 1.6 per cent.

Data revenue grew to Rs 5,810 crore, while digital portfolio revenue rose to Rs 3,016 crore.

Wipro profit falls marginally to ₹3,200.6 cr in Sept quarter

NEW DELHI: Wipro on Thursday reported a slight decline of 1.40 per cent in consolidated net profit to Rs 3,200.6 crore for Q2 FY27. The company had posted a net profit of Rs 3,246.2 crore in Q2 FY26, Wipro said in a regulatory filing.

Wipro's revenue from operations rose 9.1 per cent to Rs 24,752.7 crore in Q2 FY27, up from Rs 22,697.3 crore in Q2 FY26. Sequentially, the company's profit fell 4.5 per cent, while its revenue grew 1 per cent.

IT services segment revenue stood at $2,611.5 million, 0.1 per cent lower Q-o-Q and an increase of 0.3 per cent YoY.

Myntra posts revenue of ₹5,242.5 cr in previous fiscal

BENGALURU: Myntra Designs Pvt Ltd, which operates the Myntra fashion and lifestyle platform, reported revenue from operations of Rs 5,242.5 crore in FY26, according to the financial statements.

Excluding logistics and shipping, revenue rose 12 per cent to Rs 4,123.3 crore from Rs 3,673.3 crore, driven by advertising and marketplace services.

Advertising revenue grew 35.2 per cent to Rs 1,236.4 crore, while marketplace and collection services revenue increased 3 per cent to Rs 2,657.3 crore. Logistics revenue declined to Rs 1,119.2 crore from Rs 2,390.5 crore.

Flipkart Group FY26 revenue rises 18% to ₹1.46 lakh crore

BENGALURU: Flipkart Group's revenue from operations rose 18 per cent to Rs 1.46 lakh crore in FY26, while consolidated net loss narrowed to Rs 8,468 crore from Rs 8,646 crore a year earlier, according to regulatory filings.

Adjusted operating losses declined by Rs 1,600 crore, while adjusted EBITDA improved by Rs 1,500 crore. The adjusted operating margin improved 230 basis points to minus 5.4 per cent from minus 7.7 per cent. Flipkart Ads grew 31 per cent, while gross margins increased 23 per cent in absolute terms, reflecting improved unit economics and lower overheads.

IMPORTS JUMP 8% TO $74.61 BILLION IN SEPTEMBER

Exports rise 23% to $44.4 bn in Sept, trade deficit narrows to $30.21 bn

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15

Healthy growth in shipments of petroleum products, electronic goods and chemicals helped India's merchandise exports rise 23.04 per cent in September, while the trade deficit narrowed to $30.21 billion year-on-year due to a dip in imports of precious metals.

However, when compared to August, the deficit during the month under review widened from $26.86 billion. In September last year, it was $33 billion.

The country's exports rose to $44.40 billion from $36.08 billion in September 2025, government data released on Thursday said.

Imports rose by 8 per cent year-on-year to $74.61 billion in September.

Gold and silver imports declined by 81.27 per cent and 49.11 per cent, respectively, to $1.8 billion and 665 million during the month. Inbound shipments of crude oil, on the other hand, rose by 30.76 per cent to $18.34 billion.

Brent crude oil prices have been hovering over $100 per barrel during the last few weeks.

Cumulatively, during April-September this fiscal, exports jumped 18.51 per cent to $259.89 billion, and imports climbed 16.31 per cent to $437.53 billion. The deficit during the first half of 2026-27 widened to $177.64 billion as compared to $156.88 billion during April-September 2025-26.

Exports are maintaining their growth trend, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agarwal said in a press briefing on trade data.

He expressed the hope that if the trend continued, the country's merchandise exports would cross $500 billion. They were at $442 billion in 2025-26.

Exports of petroleum products, electronic goods and chemicals grew by 31.9 per cent ($6.2 billion), 70.44 per cent ($5.3 billion) and 24.21 per cent ($3 billion) respectively, during the month.

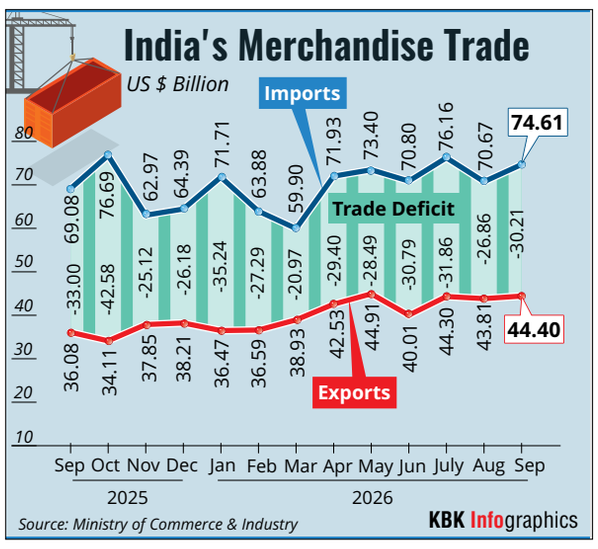
High crude oil prices amid the West Asia crisis have helped India earn better realisations from petroleum product exports.

As per government estimates, services exports stood at $36.35 billion in September, and imports were at $19.44 billion.

On services exports, the secretary said the rise in oil prices due to the West Asia crisis has impacted the exports in areas, including travel and tourism.

Commenting on the data, Federation of Indian Export Organisations (FIEO) President SC Ralhan said exporters continue to respond to global uncertainty with agility, strengthening their presence across markets and product categories.

"This strong first-half performance provides a firm foundation to advance towards India's $1 trillion export ambition. The priority now is to translate this momentum into sustained orders and deeper market penetratin," he said.



WHEN COMPARED TO AUGUST, THE DEFICIT DURING THE MONTH UNDER REVIEW WIDENED FROM $26.86 BILLION. IN SEPTEMBER LAST YEAR, IT WAS $33 BILLION

KEY POINTS

- Gold and silver imports declined by 81.27% and 49.11%, respectively, to $1.8 billion and 665 million during the month
- Inbound shipments of crude oil, on the other hand, rose by 30.76 per cent to $18.34 billion
- Cumulatively, during April-September FY27, exports rose 18.51% to $259.89 billion, imports jumped 16.31% to $437.53 billion
- The deficit during H1 FY27 widened to $177.64 billion against $156.88 billion during H1 FY26
- As per government estimates, services exports stood at $36.35 billion in September, and imports were at $19.44 billion

Passenger vehicle dispatches rise 30.7% to 13.6 lakh units in Sept qtr

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15

Domestic passenger vehicle dispatches from automakers to dealers stood at 13,60,687 units in July-September this year, registering an on-year rise of 30.7 per cent, supported by improved affordability following GST 2.0, robust demand and infrastructure-led economic activity, the Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM) said on Thursday.

According to SIAM, the automobile industry is expected to maintain positive growth momentum in H2 of FY27, though the pace of expansion may moderate due to the higher baseline from the previous year.

"Demand fundamentals remain supportive, aided by the festive season, new product launches, last-mile mobility requirements, infrastructure spending and fleet replacement. Passenger Vehicles growth will remain positive, with new launches expected to sustain consumer interest and demand," SIAM stated.

However, passenger vehicle exports stood at 2.29 lakh units in Q2, representing a 5.2 per cent decline compared with the same period last year, primarily due to a higher base and logistics constraints due to the West Asia crisis.

HOWEVER, PVEXPORTS STOOD AT 2.29 LAKH UNITS IN Q2 FY27, A 5.2% DECLINE AGAINST Q2 FY26

During April-September 2026 (H1), domestic passenger vehicles sales were 26,37,067 units, as against 20,55,122 units during H1 of last fiscal, registering 28.3 per cent growth on a year-on-year basis.

In September, domestic passenger vehicle dispatches from companies to dealers rose 21.8 per cent year-on-year to 4,54,574 units this year, as compared to 3,73,347 units in the same month last year.

Domestic two-wheeler sales rose 13.5 per cent to 24.63 lakh units last month as against 21.70 lakh units in September last year. Three-wheeler dispatches to dealers were up 16 per cent last month at 98,162 units in September 2026 as against 84,635 units in the year-ago period.

"The Indian automotive industry delivered a strong performance in the first half of FY2026-27, following a robust second quarter and a strong September 2026. This stellar performance across all segments of the automobile industry has been supported by improved affordability following GST 2.0, resilient rural and urban demand, healthy freight movement, infrastructure-led economic activity, and a gradual replacement cycle across vehicle segments," said Shenu Agarwal, President, SIAM.

Agarwal further said alternative fuel technologies are witnessing increasing acceptance and are expected to play an important role in India's sustainable mobility transition.

The Utility Vehicle (UV) sub-segment continued to dominate the PV market, accounting for 68 per cent of total PV sales. UV sales grew by 34.2 per cent in Q2 of 2026-27, compared to Q2 of 2025-26. Passenger car sales also recorded a strong double-digit growth rate of 24.9 per cent during the quarter.

Total domestic vehicle dispatches during the second quarter rose 18.2 per cent year-on-year to 83.87 lakh units, while exports grew 23.9 per cent to 20.89 lakh units.

Unemployment rate remains stable at 5% in September: Govt

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 15

India's overall unemployment rate among persons aged 15 years and above remained steady at 5 per cent in September 2026, unchanged from August, according to the National Statistics Office's (NSO) Periodic Labour Force Survey released on Thursday.

The unemployment rate was 5.2 per cent in September 2025. Rural unemployment rose marginally to 4.2 per cent from 4.1 per cent in August, while the urban rate increased to 6.9 per cent from 6.8 per cent. In September 2025, rural and urban unemployment stood at 4.6 per cent and 6.8 per cent, respectively.

Male unemployment remained stable at 4.9 per cent in September 2026, continuing the stable or declining trend since June 2026. The overall female unemployment rate edged up to 5.2 per cent from 5.1 per cent. Rural female unemployment stood at 3.9 per cent, its lowest level in 2026, while urban female unemployment rose to 9.2 per cent from 8.9 per cent.

The monthly estimates were based on information collected from 3,70,513 persons. The PLFS methodology was modified in January 2025 to provide monthly & quarterly estimates of labour force indicators.

Overall Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR) among persons aged 15 years & above rose 0.2 percentage points year-on-year to 55.5 per cent in September 2026. Urban LFPR rose to 50.7 per cent from 50.4 per cent in August 2026.

Overall female LFPR rose 0.5 percentage points year-on-year to 34.6 per cent, while rural female LFPR rose 1.0 percentage point to 38.9 per cent. Overall Worker Population Ratio rose 0.3 percentage points year-on-year to 52.7 per cent in September 2026.

Jio eyes major share in $1.4 tn digital economy

AGENCIES
Mumbai, October 15

Reliance Industries' Jio is targeting a significant share of India's projected $1.4 trillion digital economy by fiscal 2031, leveraging its 533 million customers, expanding 5G network and technology capabilities ahead of Jio Platforms' initial public offering (IPO).

"We expect a $1.4-trillion digital economy by FY31; we will take a huge market share of this," Jio Platforms Managing Director Akash Ambani said. Jio carries more than 60 per cent of India's wireless data traffic.

The company had 533.3 million customers as of June 30, 2026, including 285 million 5G users, the largest 5G customer base outside China. Average monthly data consumption per customer reached 43.7 GB in the first quarter of FY27.

Jio reported EBITDA of Rs 76,225 crore in FY26, with a compound annual growth rate of 17.8 per cent between FY24 and FY26. Its EBITDA margin stood at 53.3 per cent in the first quarter of FY27.

Its infrastructure includes 3,60,537 towers and 26,800 MHz of spectrum. Jio expects industry-wide additions of 340 million 4G and 5G customers between FY26 and FY31. It also had 28.6 million fixed broadband customers, accounting for 67.5 per cent of India's net fixed broadband additions in FY26.

Jio is targeting India's estimated Rs 5.1 trillion addressable market for enterprise digital services in FY26 and plans to monetise its technology platform in overseas markets.

Ambani said average download speeds in India had increased from about 2.5 Mbps in 2016 to around 68 Mbps nationally. Jio's average 5G download speed was 198.9 Mbps.

Further, Ambani said the country's largest telco is working on 6G technology, and will be in a position to launch it commercially in the next decade starting 2030.

Speaking to reporters ahead of the company's mega Rs 30,000-crore IPO, Ambani said the company is looking at a software-update led 6G rollout rather than fresh infrastructure buildout, hinting that the investments required to launch the next phase of telecom network will not be very heavy

Jio Platforms' IPO will open on October 21, with a fresh issue of up to 27 crore shares and no offer-for-sale component.

The Rs 10 face-value shares have a price band of Rs 1,065 to Rs 1,119, potentially raising Rs 30,213 crore at the upper end.

The IPO closes on October 23, while anchor investor bidding is scheduled for October 19. Reliance Industries owns 66.43 per cent of Jio Platforms.

Jio Financial Services Sept quarter net profit declines 51% to ₹340.44 crore



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 15

Jio Financial Services Ltd on Thursday reported a 51 per cent decline in consolidated net profit to Rs 340.44 crore for the September quarter, hit by higher expenses.

The company posted a net profit of Rs 695 crore in the year-ago period.

Its total income rose about 70 per cent to Rs 1,699.41 crore in the second quarter of FY27 from Rs 1,002.40 crore in the corresponding quarter of the previous fiscal year, according to a regulatory filing.

Interest income rose to Rs 1,257.68 crore in the July-September quarter from Rs 392.37 crore in the year-ago period.

The company's total expenses rose to Rs 1,166 crore during the quarter from Rs 436.50 crore in the corresponding period last fiscal.

Shares of Jio Financial Services settled at Rs 218.75 on the BSE, up 0.09 per cent from the previous close.

Tech Mahindra Q2 profit rises 32.74% to ₹1,585.6 cr

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 15

IT services firm Tech Mahindra on Thursday reported a 32.74 per cent increase in consolidated net profit to Rs 1,585.6 crore for the July-September quarter of FY27.

The Pune-based company had posted a net profit (attributable to owners of the company) of Rs 1,194.5 crore in the year-ago period, according to a regulatory filing by the company.

Tech Mahindra's revenue from operations rose 15.6 per cent to Rs 16,180.2 crore in Q2 FY27, up from Rs 13,994.9 crore in Q2 FY26. Sequentially, profit and revenue rose 8 per cent and 3 per cent, respectively.

The company's new deal wins stood at $1,023 million in total contract value (TCV), up 25.4 per cent from a year ago.

"Deal wins exceeding USD 1+ billion in each of the last four quarters reflect the strength of our customer relationships and the trust we have built. With 7.2 per cent year-on-year constant currency growth, we continue to sustain business momentum.

"As we celebrate our 40th anniversary this quarter, we look ahead with confidence, building on our legacy of innovation, entrepreneurship, and long-term value creation for our stakeholders," Mohit Joshi, CEO and Managing Director, Tech Mahindra, said.

Tata Trusts' two non-profits question Mehli Mistry's locus standi to raise concerns about their operations

Mistry had alleged governance lapses & conflicts of interest at the two trusts

AGENCIES
Mumbai, October 15

CLOSER LOOK

- SDTT & Bai Hirabai Jamestji Tata Navsari Charitable Institution said Mistry had completed his three-year term and could not challenge their administration and governance
- SRTT, SDTT & Bai Hirabai are separate charitable trusts with distinct governing instruments, boards, properties & accounts, opposing Mistry's request for a single proceeding, SDTT said

Two charitable trusts under Tata Trusts on Thursday questioned Mehli Mistry's locus standi to raise concerns about their operations, arguing that his trusteeship ended on October 28 last year.

In separate affidavits before the Charity Commissioner's office, Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) and Bai Hirabai Jamestji Tata Navsari Charitable Institution said Mistry, a close confidante of late Ratan Tata, had completed his three-year term and could not challenge their administration and governance.

Mistry had reportedly approached the authority alleging governance lapses and conflicts of interest at the two trusts and questioning their decision-making.

The trusts have sought a preliminary ruling on maintainability and jurisdiction before the merits of his complaints are examined or any inquiry ordered.

SDTT said Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT), SDTT and Bai Hirabai are separate public charitable trusts with distinct governing instruments, boards, properties and accounts, opposing Mistry's request for a single proceeding.

Bai Hirabai also disputed Mistry's interpretation of Clauses 6 and 18 of its Trust Deed concerning trustees' religious and residential eligibility, arguing that the restrictions conflict with the original Will and Codicil. Mistry has been given until November 5 to reply.

Separately, Bai Hirabai has sought to substitute Noel Tata as reporting trustee following the cessation of Vijay Singh as trustee earlier this year.

Mistry has asked the trust to file an affidavit confirming Noel Tata's eligibility under the 1923 trust deed, which stipulates that trustees must profess the Zoroastrian religion and be permanent residents of Mumbai or Navsari.

He also alleged that some existing trustees did not meet these criteria. In a separate hearing, SRTT informed the Charity Commissioner about difficulties arising from the office's May 15 order barring it from holding meetings.

'TO BE IMPLEMENTED ONCE WE GET COMPETITIVE ADVANTAGE'

India-US trade pact 1st phase finalised & legal drafting underway, says Goyal

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15

Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Thursday said the first phase of the India-US trade pact has been finalised and is undergoing legal drafting.

He expressed the hope that the legal drafting too would be finalised soon and operationalised once India secures a competitive advantage over its peer countries.

"US bilateral trade agreement's first tranche has been finalised and it is going through final contours, the legal drafting, and we hope to be able to finalise that soon and operationalise that once we get the comparable advantage or competitive advantage over our peer countries," Goyal said here at the SRCC Centenary Conclave.

The minister added that his comments on the US-India pact "are consistent and exactly what I've said yesterday and what I said a week ago and what I said three months ago. So nothing new in that".



Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal

THE INDIA-EU FTA WILL BE INKED IN DECEMBER AND WOULD COME INTO FORCE FROM FEBRUARY OR MARCH NEXT YEAR, HE SAID

He also said that the free trade agreement between India and the European Union will be inked in December and would come into force from February or March next year.

Later, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal said that the negotiations on the US trade pact are moving in the right direction.

"Probably we are in a very good zone. We anticipate closing the deal and signing the deal at the earliest possible time," he told reporters here.

Agarwal added that the trade deal has to be signed when the overall tariff structure would be formalised in the US.

"So there is a parallel work being done in the US also to get back the tariff structure and based on some of the outcomes under (Section) 301, we will progress towards signing the deal at a mutually agreed time," he said.

Regarding the legal drafting of the pact, Agarwal said it is going on.

"The idea is when you do a trade deal, the trade deal has also a very important component that it gives you not only market access in each other's market, it gives you preferential market access in each other's market. So in that context, India has to get a preferential market access with their competitors. And that is something which will come as a part of the new tariff framework that the US is working on," the secretary said.

On whether the framework will take into account the US Trade Representative's Section 301 investigations on concerns related to excess capacity, he said: "I think all other issues will get settled as part of the deal".

Earlier this month, India and 14 other countries called for coordinated global action to curb excess industrial production that distorts markets, hurts domestic industries and contributes to an imbalance between supply and demand.

On this, the secretary said: "Excess capacity due to non-market forces or non-market interventions has been something which India has also been opposing in a big way". He added that excess capacity being created as a result of non-market policies is detrimental to global trade.

When asked if the US' Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026, which authorises US President Donald Trump to impose tariffs up to 100 per cent on largest buyers of Russian oil and gas, will also be part of the new tariff framework, he said "hopefully when it (pact) is signed, hopefully we will have more clarification on that. But definitely India will look at more tariff stability and trade stability as a part of the deal".

Earlier this month, US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer said the US and India were working to finalise a bilateral trade deal but an agreement was not imminent.

KEY POINTS

- Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal said that the negotiations on the US trade pact are moving in the right direction
- 'Probably we are in a very good zone. We anticipate closing the deal and signing the deal at the earliest possible time,' he told reporters here
- 'There is a parallel work being done in the US also to get back the tariff structure & based on some of the outcomes under (Section) 301, we will progress towards signing the deal at a mutually agreed time," he said

IRFC posts ₹3,886 cr profit in H1

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15

IRFC, the Navratna Public Sector Enterprise of the Ministry of Railways, declared a new record half-yearly profit of Rs 3,885.69 crore for the first six months of FY27, up 10.31 per cent from Rs 3,522.67 crore in the corresponding period in FY26. The total income of the comapny jumped by 22 per cent to Rs 16,315 crore from April to September, compared to Rs 13,290.15 crore a year ago.

As per the officials, the financial performance is in line with the success of IRFC's railway-based diversification policy, which has seen the company increasing its finance portfolio from lending to Indian Railways to the allied infrastructural sectors. IRFC also has registered a record-high net worth at Rs 60,573.35 crore as on September 30, compared to Rs 56,748.76 crore at the end of March 2026.

For the September quarter of FY27, IRFC reported a PAT of Rs 1,958 crore, registering a growth of approximately 10 per cent over Rs 1,776.98 crore recorded in the same quarter of FY 26.

The annualised net interest margin for the quarter was 1.50 per cent, with management justifying the improvement in business performance due to an increasing contribution of railway-related ventures and allied industries.



IRFC Chairperson and MD Manoj Kumar Dubey

The company's board of directors announced an interim dividend of Rs 1.15 per share, the highest ever paid by the company in one instalment.

IRFC Chairperson and MD Manoj Kumar Dubey remarked that the period between April and September had been significant not just in terms of financials but also of institutional strengthening and governance. He added that the company's financial statements for FY26 have been cleared with a zero comment from CAG of India.

IRFC, according to Dubey, has been able to continue building its workforce capacity in relation to its growing business operations and diversification.

Following its IRFC 2.0 strategy, the company is trying to expand itself within the infrastructure ecosystem connected to rail while practicing fiscal responsibility and managing risks carefully.

The company sustained its zero NPA position for the quarter, despite expanding its credit portfolio within the railway-related and allied infrastructure sectors. Dubey characterised the zero NPA position as a good business model rather than a mere status symbol.

In the years to come, IRFC plans to lend to new infrastructure needs such as newly approved Dedicated Freight Corridors, high-speed rail corridors, national port expansions, and renewable energy initiatives with power purchase agreements from Indian Railways.

Other than that, the company's future lending agenda will include metro rails, rapid rail, power projects, and other infrastructure projects. This will be in line with the overall national approach by IRFC for funding development in the country.

Officials asserted that with increased demand for infrastructure funding and new infrastructure financing prospects, IRFC intends to remain profitable while keeping asset quality.

IRCTC Partners with QCI for digital, 3rd-party food safety and hygiene audit

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 15

The Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation (IRCTC) has signed an MoU with the Quality Council of India (QCI) to strengthen food safety and hygiene across its train and station catering units.

Under the pact, QCI will conduct unannounced quarterly and half-yearly inspections to ensure compliance with Food Safety and Standards Authority of India regulations.

The MoU was signed by IRCTC General Manager Sudhir Warrier and QCI Principal Advisor Subroto Ghosh.

Inspectors will use a digital application with geotagging, time-stamping and photographic evidence. Audit reports must be submitted within 24 hours, enabling corrective action tracking against defaulting vendors.

Inspections will cover staff hygiene, food storage, temperature controls, pest management and segregation of vegetarian and non-vegetarian ingredients. The agreement also allows future initiatives, including passenger satisfaction surveys, infrastructure audits and specialised staff training.

Net direct tax mop-up grows 13% to ₹13.38 lakh crore till October 14

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 15

Net direct tax collection has increased 13.21 per cent to about Rs 13.38 lakh crore so far this financial year, reaching about 50 per cent of the full year budget target.

The growth in direct tax collection between April 1 and October 14 this fiscal is driven by a robust 20 per cent growth in corporate taxes, despite a 67 per cent increase in refunds to non-corporate taxpayers, which include individuals, firms and HUFs.

Net corporate tax mop-up grew 20.58 per cent to over Rs 5.99 lakh crore, while non-corporate tax rose 5.83 per cent to about Rs 6.92 lakh crore so far this fiscal year.

Securities transaction tax (STT) kitty swelled about 52 per cent to Rs 46,840 crore till October 14 of FY27. The budget target for STT is Rs 73,700 crore for the fiscal.

The government has budgeted to collect Rs 26.97 lakh crore from direct taxes in the current financial year, a 15 per cent growth over Rs 23.40 lakh crore collected in FY26.

Of this, Rs 13.38 lakh crore or close to 50 per cent of the budget target has already been achieved as on October 14.

Price Waterhouse & Co LLP, Partner, Hitesh Sawhney, said the tax collection numbers reflect strong tax buoyancy and improved compliance. "Net corporate tax collections growth indicates healthy business performance, while the continued rise in STT collections underscores sustained investor participation in financial markets. These collection trends are consistent with India's robust GDP growth," he added.

As per the data released by the Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT), refund issuances to both corporate and non-corporate taxpayers soared 24 per cent year-on-year to Rs 2.65 lakh crore during the period.

Sensex jumps 1,534 pts, Nifty surges to nearly 3-week high led by banks, Reliance, IT stocks

The rupee appreciates by 18 paise to 94.99 against US dollar

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, October 15

Benchmark stock index Sensex rallied 1,534 points, or over 2 per cent, to close at a three-week high on Thursday, led by heavy buying in banks, IT and Reliance Industries.

The 30-share BSE Sensex jumped 1,533.72 points, or 2.11 per cent, to settle near the day's high at 74,315.61. The 50-share NSE Nifty climbed 374.65 points, or 1.66 per cent, to close at 22,997.35, its highest level since September 25.

From the 30 Sensex firms, Tech Mahindra jumped 4.61 per cent, ICICI Bank 4.17 per cent, Reliance Industries surged 4.03 per cent, Bharti Airtel 2.94 per cent, Eternal 2.77 per cent, HCLTech 2.58 per cent, HDFC Bank 2.51 per cent and TCS 2.28 per cent. Bharat Electronics, Trent and Hindustan Unilever were the laggards among Sensex shares.



Among BSE sectoral indices, Top 10 Banks surged 2.33 per cent, Pvt Banks index 1.82 per cent, IT 1.51 per cent, Focused IT 1.49 per cent, Auto 1.47 per cent, Oil & Gas 1.46 per cent & Energy 1.41 per cent.

The rupee logged the fifth straight session of gains on Thursday, appreciating 18 paise to close at 94.99 against the US dollar.

PM Modi appreciates VIT Chennai-incubated MEDxAI Innovations' AI healthcare technology

MPOST BUREAU
Chennai, October 15

Prime Minister Narendra Modi appreciated healthcare innovations developed by MEDxAI Innovations Pvt Ltd, a deep-tech startup incubated at VIT Chennai, during the inauguration of the Porur Metro Rail project in Chennai.

Narendra Modi interacted with Dr Sheena C Pravin, CEO of MEDxAI Innovations, and VIT Chennai faculty in the presence of Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay.



Dr Pravin showcased two technology platforms: Cervilens, an AI-powered cervical cancer pre-screening tool, and Quantum PharmX, an AI-powered drug discovery platform supporting molecular analysis and genomic profiling.

Founded by Dr Sheena C. Pravin and Dr Reena Monica P., CTO, the company develops indigenous artificial intelligence and quantum computational intelligence solutions for healthcare and pharmaceutical research.

The interaction followed the startup's selection for the iAccelerate Programme facilitated by iTNT Hub (Tamil Nadu Technology Hub) in June 2026. Following an online screening meeting this month, the company was selected for the interaction.

MEDxAI Innovations thanked VIT Founder and Chancellor G. Viswanathan and Vice President G.V. Selvam for their support.

CAD narrows to $5.2 bn in Aug: RBI

AGENCIES
Mumbai, October 15

India's current account deficit (CAD) narrowed to $5.2 billion in August from $6.1 billion a year ago, supported by a lower merchandise trade deficit and higher services surplus, according to the RBI data released on Thursday.

The merchandise trade deficit declined to $26.6 billion from $27.6 billion. Exports rose to $44.7 billion from $35.1 billion, while imports increased to $71.3 billion from $62.7 billion. The services trade surplus increased to $16.5 billion from $15.6 billion. Services exports rose to $35.5 billion from $31.2 billion, while imports climbed to $18.9 billion from $15.6 billion.

Net transfers, including remittances, increased to $12.8 billion from $12.2 billion, while the income account deficit widened to $8 billion from $6.3 billion.

During April-August 2026, the CAD widened to $18.3 billion from $12.8 billion. The merchandise trade deficit rose to $146 billion from $124.7 billion, while the services surplus increased to $85.8 billion from $79.9 billion. Net transfers rose to $66.8 billion from $55.6 billion.

Net FDI inflows stood at $3.3 billion in August, against an outflow of $0.1 billion a year ago. Foreign portfolio investment recorded an inflow of $1.7 billion against an outflow of $2.6 billion. Net banking capital inflows reached $64.7 billion, against an outflow of $4.7 billion. Net NRI deposits stood at $83 billion against $1 billion a year ago.

Overall balance of payments recorded a surplus of $45.4 billion in August & $58 billion in April-August 2026, against deficits of $5.6 billion & $0.8 billion, respectively, a year ago.

NTPC and Africa50 join hands to develop power projects across Africa

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 15

NTPC Limited, India's largest power utility and Africa50 have signed a Cooperation Agreement to identify, assess and develop power-generation projects and cross-border electricity trading opportunities across Africa.

The partnership will draw on NTPC's engineering and operational capabilities and Africa50's project development and financing expertise to advance commercially viable power projects, attract investment and expand reliable electricity supply for households and businesses.

Speaking on the occasion, Gurdeep Singh, Chairman and Managing Director of NTPC Limited, said: "We look forward to working with Africa50 to develop commercially viable power projects in mutually agreed countries in Africa. Combining NTPC's technical and operational experience with Africa50's project development capabilities and relationships across the continent creates a strong foundation for supporting reliable power supply and regional electricity trade."

Alain Ebobisse, Group Chief Executive Officer of Africa50, said: "Reliable and competitively priced power is central to Africa's industrial and economic transformation. This partnership combines Africa50's ability to develop, de-risk and deliver investable projects with NTPC's proven technical expertise to translate public ambition into private investment in power generation. Together, we aim to strengthen regional power systems that support industrial growth, expand trade and create jobs."

Essar Oil & Gas wins 5 CBM blocks across 3 states

Adds 1,281 sq kms of acreage & around 6.6 TCF of gas-in-place resources

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 15

Essar Oil & Gas Ltd has secured five coal-bed methane (CBM) blocks across West Bengal, Madhya Pradesh and Telangana, adding 1,281 square kilometres of acreage and an estimated 6.6 trillion cubic feet (TCF) of gas-in-place resources.

The contracts, awarded under the government's Special CBM bidding rounds of 2025 and 2026, were signed on Thursday, the company said.



Two blocks covering 330 square kilometres in West Bengal's Raniganj will expand its acreage there from 500 square kilometres to 830 square kilometres. The company also secured a block in Madhya Pradesh's Singrauli basin and entered Telangana's Godavari Valley.

"The award of these five CBM blocks marks a significant milestone in Essar Oil & Gas' growth journey," CEO Pankaj Kalra said.

Essar has invested more than Rs 6,000 crore in exploration and production at Raniganj and currently produces 9,50,000 standard cubic metres of gas per day (SCMD), accounting for nearly 50 per cent of India's CBM production.

Chairman Bhuwan Chandra Tripathi said the group remains focused on supporting India's energy security through responsible development of domestic hydrocarbon resources.

Essar Oil & Gas aims to contribute 5 per cent of India's natural gas production by developing its CBM portfolio.

The company has a resource base of 12 TCF of CBM and shale gas and has produced more than 105 billion cubic feet of CBM to date.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Pankaj S/o Dhaneswar R/o Gali No-04, Kamal Vihar Karawal Nagar Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 39875/2017 U/s 482/411/34 IPC at PS: Bhajanpura, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Pankaj** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Pankaj** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Pankaj of FIR No. 39875/2017 U/s 482/411/34 IPC of PS: Bhajanpura, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 15.11.2026.**

By order
Kirandeep Kaur
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01
Court Room No.05,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/14716/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Randhir @ Kalu @ Bhanda, R/o H.No. 200, Metro Gate No. 2, Navada, Delhi, Sarai Rohilla, North, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 115/2022, U/s 392/394/397/450 IPC, P.S. Sarai Rohilla, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Randhir @ Kalu @ Bhanda** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Randhir @ Kalu @ Bhanda** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Randhir @ Kalu @ Bhanda** accused of **FIR No. 115/2022, U/s 392/394/397/450 IPC, P.S. Sarai Rohilla, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.11.2026.**

By Order - Sh. Bhupender Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, Central
Room No. 154 , Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/14776/N/2026

GOVERNMENT OF PUNJAB

AMRITSAR DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

PUDA Bhawan, SGRD Urban Estate, Airport Road, Amritsar

Tender/RFP Reference No.D. E (C) ASR//2026/10626-10637 dated 15-10-2026

Estate Officer, Galiara Project, Amritsar invites online bids for **"Operation and maintenance of Saragari multilevel parking and Kesri Bagh parking complex under Galiara Project, Amritsar on License basis."**

Closing date & time: 16-11-2026 at 11:00 A.M.

For details log on to: **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

Note: Any corrigendum (s) to the tender notice shall be published on the above website only.

PR-Advt. No :- 1320/12/2026-27/16242

WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice-Kota Division-Civil Engineering

No-W.623/15 Dt. 13.10.2026

Sr.Divisional Engineer (Coordination), West Central Railway, Kota for and on behalf of President of Union of India invites following open E. tenders. **Sr.No.01-Tender No.-**182-2026, **Description of work-**Kota Division: Comprehensive repair of facade, Administrative building, conference room & section offices and Construction of male changing room and rooms above PPIO in' Electric Loco Shed Tughlakabad. **Approx. Cost-**2,70,53,921.90, **Earnest Money-**5,41,100.00, **Last Date and Time of Submission of Tender-**15.30 Hrs. on date 30.10.2026, **Sr.No.02-Tender No.-**183-2026, **Description of work-**Kota Division: Improvement of Utsav railway institute located in Tughlakabad. **Approx. Cost-**70,66,905.33, **Earnest Money-**1,41,300.00, **Last Date and Time of Submission of Tender-**15.30 Hrs. on date 27.10.2026, **Sr.No.03-Tender No.-**189-2026, **Description of work-**Provision of new type II quaters (SGZ-6, GOH-04, LNR-04) On replacement account in ADEN/SGZ section. **Approx. Cost-**2,90,94,338.77, **Earnest Money-**5,81,900.00, **Last Date and Time of Submission of Tender-**15.30 Hrs. on date 30.10.2026, **Sr.No.04-Tender No.-**190-2026R, **Description of work-**Kota Division: Cleaning of Manhole, inspection chamber, dug well, septik tank and sewage line in Railway colony & ELS TKD at Tughlkabad for 3 years. **Approx. Cost-**8,48,667.77, **Earnest Money-**17,000.00, **Last Date and Time of Submission of Tender-**15.30 Hrs. on date 03.11.2026, **Sr.No.05-Tender No.-**191-2026, **Description of work-**MAKHOLI-MATHURA -Section -TRR(P)-4.307 kms with 60kg rails, TTR(FS) - 06 sets, TFR - 11.604 Kms and TFR(R) - 1.934 kms. **Approx. Cost-**90,45,679.51, **Earnest Money-**1,80,900.00, **Last Date and Time of Submission of Tender-**15.30 Hrs. on date 03.11.2026, **Sr.No.06-Tender No.-**192-2026, **Description of work-**(1) Replacement of old/dilapidated type-II quarters (RNT-04 No., RWJ-04 No total 08 No.) at KOTA -SWM Section. (2) SWM- Improvement of SRH and ORH at SWM., (3) Construction of service building for railway Magistrate court / offices at SWM station.(4) Improvement to road Latiya nallah to TRD colony at SWM railway colony. **Approx. Cost-**3,02,02,371.70, **Earnest Money-**6,04,100.00, **Last Date and Time of Submission of Tender-**15.30 Hrs. on date 03.11.2026, **Sr.No.07-Tender No.-**193-2026, **Description of work-**NAD-KOTA Section: Improvement to track drainage system by provision of RCC drain along the track between Alaniya-Daddevi stations under the jurisdiction of ADEN-RMA. **Approx. Cost-**3,88,77,259.46, **Earnest Money-**7,77,600.00, **Last Date and Time of Submission of Tender-**15.30 Hrs. on date 03.11.2026, **Sr.No.08-Tender No.-**194-2026, **Description of work-**GAROTH DEPOT :- Supply of 100000 cum. 65mm. size machine crushed stone ballast of approved quality and loading into hoppers/wagon at. **Approx. Cost-**6,66,76,096.00, **Earnest Money-**13,33,500.00, **Last Date and Time of Submission of Tender-**15.30 Hrs. on date 03.11.2026. Complete details are available in the E- tender notice uploaded on the railway web site www.ireps.gov.in and also placed on the notice board of the Sr. Divisional Engineer (Coordination), DRM Office, West Central Railway Kota's office.

(SD.)
Sr. Divisional Engineer (Coordination) WCR/KOTA

स्वच्छ भारत अभियान, एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. Dy CE/Br/L/AGC/ROB-1343/3 **Date: 14.10.2026**

PUBLIC NOTICE

The general public is hereby informed that the reconstruction of **Kheria Mod Road Over Bridge (ROB 1343/3) under Agra Division** is scheduled to be undertaken. In this connection, a notice had earlier been issued by the Railway Administration regarding the complete closure of road traffic over the said **ROB** for a period of **90 days** with effect from **09:00 hrs. on 13.10.2026**. However, the said closure was postponed due to unavoidable circumstances. Accordingly, it is hereby notified that road traffic over the said **ROB** shall remain completely closed for a period of **90 days** with effect from **17.10.2026** to facilitate the reconstruction work. During the closure period, in the interest of railway safety and public safety, and to ensure the smooth movement of road traffic, alternative routes, such as the route from **Arjun Nagar Tiraha via Barah Khamba Double Phatak Road (LC No. 75)**, have been designated for the movement of road traffic. The general public is, therefore, requested to use the designated alternative routes during the aforesaid period and extend their cooperation to the Railway Administration in the execution of this essential work being undertaken in the interest of railway safety and public safety.

Dy. Chief Engineer/Bridge/Line
North Central Railway, Agra

2356/26(K)

North central railways | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in | @CPRONCR

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA

Executive Engineer Central Mumbai Electrical Division P.W.D.Worli, Mumbai

TENDER NOTICE NO. 22/ 2026-27

E-Tender for 60 Works in B-1 form are invited by the Executive Engineer, Central Mumbai Electrical Division, P.W.D.Worli Mumbal (Phone - 022/45646881) from the registered contractors in appropriate class of Public Works Electrical Department of Govt. of Maharashtra.

1 Below Rs.10 Lakh - 46 works

2 Above Rs.10 Lakh - 14 works (E-Tenders)

All infomiation related to this tender is made available on following website. Also, all the changes will be made available on this website.

For Below Rs.10 Lakh works - **http://mahapwd.gov.in (Pay PWD Online)**

For Above Rs.10 Lakh works **http://mahatenders.gov.in**

OW/No-EE/CMED/TENDER/3741/2026 Dt. 08.10.2026

Executive Engineer
Central Mumbai Electrical
Division P.W.D.Worli

Dgipr/2026-27/3261

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2) (i) Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Praveen S/o** Lt. Kalicharan **R/o** H.No. 627, D-2 Block, New Rajeev Colony, Madarse Wali Gali, Bhalswa Dairy, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence under **FIR No.206/19 U/s 380/411/34 IPC**., has been registered at **PS: Burari, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Praveen** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Praveen** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Praveen** of under **FIR No.206/19 U/s 380/411/34 IPC**., Registred at: **PS: Burari, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **23.11.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Payal Singal
JMFC-09, Room No. 286
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/14615/N/2026
(Court Notice)

SOUTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE.No.SR-TVC0SnT (TEND)/3/2026/15
Dated: 14.10.2026

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer, Southern Railway, Thiruvananthapuram-14 for and on behalf of the President of India invites e-tenders for the following work.

Sl.No	Tender No	Name of work
1	TVC-SNT-SIG-26-27-15	Comprehensive Annual maintenance (CAMC) contract for the KYOSAN make EI Systems at Kumbalam (KUMM), Turavur (TUVR) & Ochira (OCR) stations for Three years in Thiruvananthapuram Division
2	TVC-SNT-SIG-26-27-20	Comprehensive Annual maintenance (AMC) contract for the ANSALDO make EI System at GURUVAYUR station in ADSTE/ERS section for Three years in Thiruvananthapuram Division
3	TVC-SNT-SIG-26-27-16	Comprehensive Annual maintenance (AMC) contract for the MEDHA make EI Systems and IPS at VARD, KRPP, CGV, CGY, TRVL, PVRD, ERN, AFK & ERS stations for Three years in Thiruvananthapuram Division
4	TVC-SNT-SIG-26-27-27	Comprehensive Annual Repair Contract of M/s SUKHILA make Integrated Power Supply (IPS) system for a period of three years in Thiruvananthapuram Division
5	TVC-SNT-SIG-26-27-26	Provision of S&T arrangements in connection with shifting of crossovers at VARKALA yard of Thiruvananthapuram Division

Sl. No.	Cash Value (Approx.) (₹)	Earnest Money Deposit (₹)	Last Date for Receipt of Tender
1	91,76,760.00	1,83,500.00	05/11/2026 up to 15:00 Hrs
2	52,88,001.00	1,05,800.00	05/11/2026 up to 15:00 Hrs
3	3,06,08,364.63	6,12,200.00	05/11/2026 up to 15:00 Hrs
4	46,15,613.42	92,300.00	05/11/2026 up to 15:00 Hrs
5	1,09,93,721.73	2,19,900.00	05/11/2026 up to 15:00 Hrs

Complete details & tender document will be available at www.ireps.gov.in

Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer
Southern Railway, Thiruvananthapuram - 14

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Vivek Shukla, S/o.: Kailash Chand Shukla, R/o.: E-1-207, LIG Flat, Sector-11, Rohini, Delhi-110085** Also at: **Mohalla Chanduvara, Narnaul, District Mahendergarh, Haryana-123001** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **CC No.11/2021 U/S 138 NI Act** registered at **P.S. Shahbad Dairy, Outer North District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said accused **Vivek Shukla** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Vivek Shukla** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Vivek Shukla**, accused of **CC No.11/2021 U/S 138 NI Act, P.S. Shahbad Dairy, Outer North District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **23.11.2026.**

By Order, Sh. Akash Sharma
Judicial Magistrate First Class-North,
Court No. 213, Second Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/14564/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS!

TEMPORARY SHIFTING OF PLATFORMS OF SELECTED TRAINS AT NEW DELHI RAILWAY STATION

It is informed to the general public that, the platform numbers of the following trains at New Delhi railway station have been changed temporarily with effective from 16.10.2026 to 17.11.2026. The details are as under:-

LIST OF TRAINS WHOSE PLATFORM WILL BE SHIFTED

Train No.	Train Name	Schedule Arr.	Schedule Dep.	Existing Platform	Revised Platform
12562	New Delhi - Jaynagar	—	21:15	13	01
12561	Jaynagar - New Delhi	15:45	---	12	07
12046	Chandigarh - New Delhi	15:20	---	02	01
15306	Rohtak Jn - New Delhi	15:45	---	07	02
19566	Dehradun - Okha	13:10	13:25	01	04
12472/74/76/78	Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Katra - Bandra Terminus / Gandhidham Jn / Hapa / Jamnagar	21:25	21:40	01	08
12392	New Delhi - Rajgir	---	13:10	08	01
22435	Varanasi Jn - New Delhi	23:00	---	16	06
64441/64410	Ghaziabad - New Delhi - Ghaziabad	18:10	18:30	14	12
54473	Delhi Jn - Saharanpur Jn	18:40	18:45	15	6
64409/64076	Ghaziabad - New Delhi - Palwal	23:45	00:15	08	09
64016	Shakurbasti - Palwal	15:08	15:10	01	04

For any other information passengers are requested to contact RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or may visit Indian Railways website https://enquiry.indianrail.gov.in or NTES App.

Visit RailMadad website:
www.railmadad.indianrailways.gov.in
Download RailMadad App.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
visit us at: www.nr.indianrailways.gov.in

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE Please join us on

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform public in general that Kotak Mahindra bank Ltd has organized an auction in below mention respect of Vehicles.

VEHICLES FOR SALE

1) TATA MOTORS T_INTRAV20 REG. NO. DL1LAM6448-YOM- NA

2) TATA MOTORS T_INTRAV20 REG. NO. DL1LAL5144 -YOM 2023

UNDER HYPOTHECATION WITH M/S KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK IS UNDER SALE IN ITS "AS IS WHERE IS CONDITION" INTERESTED PARTIES CAN GIVE THEIR QUOTATIONS WITH IN 7 DAYS AT BRANCH ADDRESS: KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK 3RD FLOOR, PLOT NO 7, SECTOR 125, NOIDA-201313 OR CONTACT : RAMAN AHUJA KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK LTD. CONTACT NO. 8377988238 EMAIL-raman.ahuja@kotak.com

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

ICICI Bank Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Sachin Kulshreshtha/ Shikha Kulshreshtha/ LBNOD00002379019	Flat- No 2006, 20th Floor, Tower- A3, Rudra Palace Heights, Situated At Gh-02B, Sector-1, Greater Noida (West) Uttar Pradesh- 201307/ October 14, 2026	July 29, 2026 Rs. 1,38,01,152.60/-	Delhi NCR
2.	Nikhil Yadav/ Vandita/ LBGUR00004121099	Flat No 1302, 13th Floor, Tower G1, "ECO Village-1" Situated At Plot No.08, Sector-1, Greater Noida, Gautam Budh Nagar Uttar Pradesh- 201303/ October 14, 2026	July 28, 2026 Rs. 1,30,03,681.34/-	Delhi NCR
3.	Bhupal Singh Negi/ Soni Negi/ LBDEL00004351441	Flat No E- 1401, 14th Floor, Tower E, Skytech Matrott Situated At Plot No Gh 01/D Sector 76 Noida Uttar Pradesh- 201301/ October 14, 2026	July 21, 2026 Rs. 84,13,325.71/-	Delhi NCR

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: October 16, 2026
Place: Delhi/ NCR

Sincerely Authorised Officer
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender No.: PRYJ-Sig-410-2026-27 **Dated:** 13.10.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Coordination/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite **E-TENDER** on prescribed form for the following works up to **15.00 hrs.** on **04.11.2026.** The detail of the Tender is as under:-

Name of Work: Sectional Signaling Maintenance Contract (SSMC) in ALJN-GZB section of PRYJ Division.

Approx. Cost of Work (In Rs.): ₹ 7087241.49 (Rs. Seventy Lakhs Eighty Seven Thousand Two Hundred Fourty One and Fourty- Nine Paisa Only)

Bid Security/Earnest Money (In Rs.): ₹141800.00 | **Completion Period:** 12 Months

Date of Closing of Tender : 04.11.2026

Availability of tender form: Tender forms shall be available on **www.ireps.gov.in** 21 days prior to date of opening of the tender. **Earnest Money to be deposited:** The prescribed amount of Earnest Money as mentioned above must be deposited along with the tender form. The tenderer(s) should note that, Tenders without earnest money shall be summarily rejected. **Time, Date & Place of opening of Tender:** Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj on or after Pre-determined date at **15.30 hours.** In case tender opening date happens to be holiday, Tenders will be opened on the next working day. **Validity of offer:** 60 days from the date of opening. **Right of Railway to deal with Tender:** Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. **2341/26 (A)**

North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

ICICI Bank Branch office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

PUBLIC NOTICE
Builder Cancellation

This is to bring to your notice that ARPAN RAI / BABITA RAI (borrower/s) has availed Home loan facility vide facility agreement number LBNOD00002122472 located at B-18/5 18TH FLOOR TOWER B, HIMALAYA PRIDE PLOT NO 10B, SECTOR TECHZONE IV, GREATER NOIDA 201307. The borrower/s has failed to pay the contractual amount to the builder as per the terms and conditions of the agreement. The Bank had informed the same to the borrower through letter dated Oct 09, 2026, informing that HIMALAYA REALESTATE PVT. LTD. has cancelled the allotment of the above mentioned property. You are therefore requested to resolve this matter with the builder within 7 days from the date of this publication.

Please take further notice that post cancellation of the allotment of the said property ICICI Bank shall not be bound and/or responsible for any other allotment done by the builder.

Dated: October 16, 2026
Place : Delhi/ NCR

For ICICI Bank Limited
Sd-

UJVN LIMITED

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Letter No: 954 **Corrigendum No.01** Date: 15/10/2026

Tender No. 32/EE(Gen)/MB-II/2026-27,
Tender ID-2026_UJVNL_100726_1
Through this corrigendum, BOQ Item S.N. 01, 02 and technical specification for PTZ camera mentioned at page no.28 are amended as below:

1. BOQ Amendments:
Sl. No. 01: 5.0 MP in place of 2.0 MP.
Sl. No. 02: 4.0 MP in place of 2.0 MP.

2. Amendment to Technical Specifications:
PTZ IP Camera: IR distance 200 M in place of 300 M.
Other terms & condition shall remain same.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the e-procurement portal **"http://uktenders.gov.in"**

Executive Engineer (Generation)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

UJVN LTD.

H.O.: 'UJJWAL', Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone: 0135 - 2763808, Fax 0135-2763508
CIN No. : U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website : www.ujvnl.com

Letter No 955 **Tender Time Extension Notice-1** Dated 15.10.2026

Due to unavoidable circumstances the date of submission and opening of following tender invited by the office of the Executive Engineer (Gen.), MB-II, Chinyalisaur (Uttarkashi) is hereby extended asfollows:

Tender No.28/EE (GEN)/MB-II/2026-27: Servicing and Testing of 11 kv VCB and 415 v ACB at MB-II, Dharasu Power House.
Last date of submission of bids on website: - 21.10.2026 up to 11:00 Hrs.
Date of opening of bids: - 24.10.2026 up to 11:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit Nigam's website **"www.ujvnl.com.**

Executive Engineer (Generation)
Dharasu Power House

"Avoid Wasteful use of Electricity"

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) DIVISION GANDHI NAGAR JAMMU

SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Short e-NIT No. DGN/90of 2026-27 Dated 14-10-2026

For and on behalf of the **Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmire**-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works :-

S. No	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advertised Cost (Rs. Lakh)	Cost of document (in Rs.)	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Time Allowed for completeon	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	Improvement & Up-gradation of drain along the Main road of Chowadhi and other allied works (Under Permanent Restoration SASCI-I for the year 2026-27)	PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar	63.41	1500	126820 (2% of the Advertised Cost)	02 Months	(1200 Hrs) on or after 28-10-2026	"A" Class
2	Improvement & Up-gradation of road from Sunjwan Morh to Macca Chowk Bathindi (Under Permanent Restoration SASCI-I for the year 2026-27)	PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar	40.00	600	80000 (2% of the Advertised Cost)	02 Months	(1200 Hrs) on or after 28-10-2026	"A" & "B" Class

Position of AAA : Accorded bySuperintending Engineer PWD (R&B) Circle South Jammu vide order No. 129 of 2026 dated 12-10-2026 amounting to `63.41 Lacs for item No. 1 and ` 40.00 Lacs for item No. 2.
Position of TS : Under Process.
Project Authority:- Superintending Engineer PWD (R&B) Circle South Jammu.
Major Head of Account :- Under Permanent Restoration SASCI-I for the year 2026-27.

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the departmental website **http://jktenders.gov.in** as per below schedule :

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	14-10-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 14-10-2026 to 27-10-2026, 1800 Hrs
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	19-10-2026 at 1300 Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar Jammu
4	Bid submission Start Date	14-10-2026
5	Bid Submission End Date	27-10-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	28-10-2026 on or after 1200 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar Jammu
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids (Online)	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

Sd/- (Er. Karanjeet Sing)
Executive Engineer
PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar

DIP No:DIP/J-12531/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Shahjad @ Rihan, S/o Irshad, R/o H.No. B-190, Gali No. 02, Chand Bagh, Bhajanpura, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 12104/2021, U/s 379 IPC, P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Shahjad @ Rihan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Shahjad @ Rihan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Shahjad @ Rihan** accused of **FIR No. 12104/2021, U/s 379 IPC, P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.11.2026.**

By Order - Ms. Norma Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
North East District, Room No. 22
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/14696/NE/2026

Swiatek boosts WTA Finals bid at Wuhan Open

She ground out a 6-1, 6-4 win over American Ashlyn Krueger to reach the quarterfinals

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Wuhan, October 15

Iga Swiatek kept up her push to qualify for the WTA Finals as she ground out a 6-1, 6-4 win over American Ashlyn Krueger to reach the quarterfinals of the Wuhan Open and take advantage of a loss for Karolina Muchova on Thursday.

Krueger, in the draw as a lucky loser after defeat in qualifying, was able to put pressure on Swiatek for parts of the second set, despite racking up 44 unforced errors to the Polish player's 27. Swiatek could face another American in the quarterfinals as Ann Li was playing Indonesia's Janice Tjen later Thursday.

Winning the title would allow Swiatek to put pressure on Muchova in the Race to the WTA Finals



rankings ahead of the season-ending event next month in Indian Wells, California. Swiatek, who's reached the finals each year since 2021, is 10th in the Race with the top eight qualifying. Wimbledon finalist and sixth-seeded Muchova lost 7-5, 6-3 to 11th-seeded Diana Shnaider, who next plays former French Open champion Jelena Ostapenko.

Fifth-seeded Elina Svitolina broke Guo Hanyu's serve in the opening and final games and beat the Chinese wild-card entry 6-1, 6-4 to advance to the quarterfinals.

Guo was coming off a breakout run, including her first career top-20 win in the first round against Sorana Cirstea despite being ranked 240th.

Elina Svitolina, who lost in the quarterfinals at the China Open last week to eventual champion Zheng Qinwen, next plays Sonay Kartal after the British player stunned Jasmine Paolini 6-2, 6-0 in barely an hour. Tenth-seeded young American Iva Jovic was upset 6-4, 6-1 by Maja Chwalinska On Wednesday, top-seeded Aryna Sabalenka and second-seeded Jessica Pegula lost their second-round matches.

It marked two straight losses for Sabalenka, who was beaten by Nikola Bartunkova in the third round at the China Open last week and had a bye in the opening round at Wuhan.

Ranji: Suryansh Shedge named in Mumbai's 16-member squad

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, October 15

All-rounder Suryansh Shedge and Angkrish Raghuvanshi were on Thursday named in Mumbai's 16-member squad for their next Ranji Trophy Elite Group D clash against Himachal Pradesh in Bilaspur.

Mumbai will play their second round match from October 18 to 21 with changes to their top order.

With a right hamstring injury sidelining vice-captain Ayush Mhatre, and India opener Yashasvi Jaiswal linking up with the India 'A' side for their three-match unofficial Test series in New Zealand, Mumbai will have a new pair of openers.

Raghuvanshi and Divyaansh Saxena are thus likely to form the new opening pair.

Beyond the Bullseye: How India is building its archery talent pipeline

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 15

From a 3,000 bow in Amravati to a new 13.28-crore archery academy in Mizoram, India's Asian Games success reflects a wider effort to take the sport to more young athletes, and give emerging talent the support to compete at the highest level.

For a family that makes cardboard boxes for sweet shops, 3,000 is not an insignificant sum. For Kumkum Anil Mohod's family, it helped buy something far more valuable than a piece of sporting equipment: a chance for their daughter to pursue a dream.

Growing up in Amravati, Maharashtra, Kumkum began archery with a modest wooden bow bought with help from her grandmother.

The journey that followed was built not in a day, but through years of practice, competition and the determination to keep going.

At 17, she reached a stage few athletes ever do. At the 2026 Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya, she won the women's individual recurve gold, becoming the first Indian woman to claim the title.

She had already helped India win its first-ever women's team recurve gold at the Games.

Kumkum's story is moving because of the distance between that first bow and the podium.

But it is also a reminder that talent often emerges long before the resources needed to nurture it are in place.

A young archer needs more than the will to practise: the right equipment, committed coaches, financial support and opportunities to compete against stronger opponents can determine how far that promise travels.

India's nine-medal archery campaign at Aichi-Nagoya—five gold, two silver and two bronze—suggests that the country's success is no longer



confined to a single champion or event. Behind the medals is a wider effort to strengthen the sport, from national competitions and athlete development programmes to new training facilities such as the proposed archery academy in Mizoram.

For the Archery Association of India (AAI), expanding that pathway is central to sustaining the country's recent gains.

The association's structure includes national championships across sub-junior, junior and senior categories, alongside National Ranking Archery Tournaments. With support from NTPC, around 53 national tournaments and championships have been organised, accounting for approximately 24,096 participant entries. Support has also covered kits and uniforms for Indian archers at international competitions, with around 1,145 athlete participations recorded across 88 events.

NTPC's involvement spans both competitive exposure and longer-term development.

The company began supporting archery through AAI under its corporate social responsibility programme in November 2018, with an initial commitment of 16.18 crore through 2025.

THE ASSOCIATION'S STRUCTURE INCLUDES NATIONAL CHAMPIONSHIPS ACROSS SUB-JUNIOR, JUNIOR AND SENIOR CATEGORIES, ALONGSIDE NATIONAL RANKING ARCHERY TOURNAMENTS

In September 2025, the partnership was renewed for four years, with a commitment of 24.20 crore.

A separate agreement signed in 2022 with the National Sports Development Fund (NSDF) and the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports committed 115 crore over five years for archery development. The NTPC-supported Dhanurvidya Project focuses on grassroots talent identification, academy development, coach training, scholarships, equipment and competitive exposure, including support for women and para archers. Its implementation period has been extended to March 2030.

The approach is also taking shape through new infrastructure. On 8 October, NTPC Bongaigaon signed a Memorandum of Agreement with the Mizoram State Sports Council to establish an archery academy at Lengpui in Mamit district, with a financial commitment of 13.28 crore over three years. The proposed facility will provide professional coaching, modern equipment and structured training for young athletes preparing for district-, state- and national-level competitions.

The state sports council will implement and maintain the academy, while NTPC Bongaigaon will provide financial assistance and monitor progress.

The Mizoram project adds a regional dimension to the wider effort: developing facilities closer to aspiring athletes and creating more opportunities to enter organised training.

At the programme level, AAI has also identified priorities such as timely scholarships and equipment, stronger academy accountability, performance reviews over three to five years, sports science and injury prevention, and career pathways for experienced archers to remain involved as coaches.

India's nine-medal Asian Games campaign has provided a compelling measure of what its archers can achieve.

The work now underway—from national competitions and athlete support to coach development and the proposed Mizoram academy—is aimed at strengthening the foundations beneath those performances.

The ambition is not just to celebrate the next champion, but to give more young archers the opportunity, preparation and support to become one.

FILM



ISHITA GETS **NERVOUS** AROUND AJAY DEVGN & TABU

'I don't want them giving retakes because of me,' says Dutta about her 'Drishyam' co-stars

Ishita Dutta may be familiar with the 'Drishyam' set, but she said sharing the screen with Ajay Devgn and Tabu never stops being a challenge. Playing Devgn's daughter in the franchise, she calls every outing with them a chance to learn something new. As 'Drishyam: The Final Conclusion' continues to do well, she opened up about the pressure that comes with matching up to two of the industry's finest actors. She also spoke about how Devgn's confidence as an actor means he is always willing to give his co-stars their moment.

Speaking to 'The Free Press Journal', Ishita admitted that the nerves haven't fully gone away, even though she has worked with Ajay Devgn and Tabu before. "I still feel intimidated by Ajay Devgn and Tabu. I need to get out of it, that thing that I have to make sure that I give my best because I don't want them to be giving retakes because of me. That pressure, I don't know why I always feel it. You know, it takes me a little time, honestly, still today, to get over that. The first two or three days are a little bit like that, then I get into my comfort zone. Because, I mean, how can I not? I mean, they are such legends, like such great performers that, like, one look and they express everything. So, I also feel I'm lucky to work with them, to see their process and to learn also so much from them," she said.

Ishita praised Ajay for letting his co-stars shine, saying his behaviour on set shows he understands what makes a film work. "The majority of my films have been with Ajay sir. And wherever I have worked, I have not come across somebody who feels insecure like that. So, I don't know what it's like to work on a set like that. A great actor would know that a film does well if everybody does well, right?" she said.

AGENCIES

ISHITA CALLS EVERY OUTING WITH THEM A CHANCE TO LEARN SOMETHING NEW

Celebrate 'Sacred Flavours of Navratri' at Eros Hotel New Delhi

Celebrating the spirit of devotion and festive indulgence, Eros Hotel New Delhi presents 'Sacred Flavours of Navratri', a special culinary offering at Blooms and Singh Sahib. The promotion brings together festive favourites and vegetarian delicacies to mark the auspicious occasion.

The menu features an array of flavourful preparations at Blooms, including Gulab Kesar Thandai, Paneer Pinwheel Tikka, Anardana Aloo Tikki and Pomegranate Fruit Chaat. Guests can also savour comforting Indian preparations such as Seb ki Subzi and Chutney Wala Paneer, alongside a selection of traditional accompaniments. For those with a sweet tooth, Makhana Tres Leches adds a contemporary touch to the festive spread.

Venue:
Blooms, Tea Lounge and Singh Sahib
Date:
Till October 19, 2026
Time:
7 pm - 11 pm (Singh Sahib), Noon to 3 pm & 7 pm - 11 pm (Blooms) and 9 am - 9 pm (Tea Lounge)
Starting price:
Rs 495 plus taxes

The special 'Navratri Thali' at Singh Sahib brings together a selection of vegetarian preparations and festive favourites, offering guests a wholesome dining experience. The offering celebrates the flavours of the season while providing an opportunity to gather with family and friends over a festive meal.

Guests can visit Eros Hotel New Delhi to enjoy a festive culinary experience that brings together familiar flavours and the spirit of the occasion.

MPOST





DAKSHIN PRABHATAM

A weekend celebration of South Indian breakfast traditions

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Sheraton New Delhi Hotel invites guests to embark on a delightful culinary journey through the diverse flavours of South India with 'Dakshin Prabhatam', a specially curated breakfast experience at its celebrated South Indian speciality restaurant, Dakshin. Available exclusively on Saturdays and Sundays, from 9 am to 11 am, the experience celebrates the region's rich culinary heritage through authentic recipes, traditional preparations and comforting morning favourites.

Inspired by the distinctive food traditions of Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Puducherry, 'Dakshin Prabhatam' brings together an enticing selection of regional delicacies, traditional tiffin, freshly ground chutneys and South Indian breakfast classics. Each preparation reflects the simplicity, authenticity and depth of flavour that define the region's culinary landscape.



Guests can savour a thoughtfully curated à la carte menu featuring beloved South Indian specialities, complemented by the warmth of traditional hospitality and the distinctive dining ambience of Dakshin. From the comforting flavours of freshly prepared breakfast favourites to the aromatic indulgence of a traditional South Indian filter coffee, every element is designed to offer a memorable start to the weekend.

With 'Dakshin Prabhatam', Sheraton New Delhi Hotel continues to celebrate India's diverse regional cuisines, bringing authentic culinary experiences to the capital while honouring the traditions, ingredients and flavours that have made South Indian cuisine cherished across generations.

For reservations and further information, contact: 9220551562 (9 am - 6 pm)
Email: mytable.snd@itchotels.com